



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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Correction of errors of substance may be made only on the floor of the House with the permission of the Speaker. However, correction of typographical or grammatical errors which Members suggest for the Bound Volumes which will be compiled at the end of the Meeting may be clearly marked in the Daily Report, and the copy containing the corrections submitted at the Editor's Office, Parliament House, not later than four clear days after the publication of the Daily Report.

BOUND VOLUMES of the Official Report (each with a comprehensive Index) are issued periodically during the Session. There is no fixed subscription rate, but prices will be quoted on each publication.

*Published by Office of Chamber Reporting,
Parliament House, Accra.*

*Designed and Printed by Publishing Department,
Parliament House, Accra.*

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Friday, 18th July, 2025

The House met at 10.58 a.m.

[THE FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 5 — Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 17th July, 2025, under consideration.

Page 1...7—

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, at page 7, the item numbered 27, I was conspicuously present in this House yesterday, but I have been marked absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, kindly take note.

Page 8—

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, at page 8, the item numbered (b)(ii), with regard to the visit by the staff and students of Akatsi College of Education, right at your backyard, the name of the lecturer who brought them here is captured as “Bridget Aku Dorekenoo”. I guess the actual name should be Dorkenoo, so the “e” after the D-o-r should be deleted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are right. Table, take note.

Page 9...10 — Page 9 or 10?

Mr Afriyie: No, page 9.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, at page 9, the item numbered 6(a), line 4, I humbly suggest that the Clerks-at-the-Table delete the word after “Deputy” and insert “Ministers”. In its current form, “i” is missing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you are right. Table, take note; the spelling of Minister is wrong.

Page 10...12—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, at page 12, the first sentence at the top reads,

“The Rt Hon Speaker withdrew from the Chair at 5.06 p.m.

The Hon First Deputy Speaker took the Chair.”

Mr Speaker, if you look at page 11 and 12, there was an important incident that I think the *Votes and Proceedings* would have captured. The able Majority Leader had drawn the attention of the Speaker to an issue. The Speaker gave certain directives which led to the walkout of the Minority. Even though this is not the *Official Report*, I think that it cannot be ignored. I think it happened just before you took over, so such an item should have come before other issues followed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, look at page 15. The incidents that happened are captured at page 14 and 15. Or you want the chronology?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, rightly so, because I think the *Vote and Proceedings* gives us a brief on exactly how it happened. You took over from the Rt Hon Speaker and page 15 is when you were presiding, but the incident happened before you took over. If it is the case that it is all right, I do not have any problem with that, but that was what I thought.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Page 13...14—

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I need your clarification on pages 12 and 14. Under the item

numbered 269, when you look at the last paragraph, you directed that the Question be deemed as—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it the Question numbered 269?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: That is so, Mr Speaker.

The last paragraph, according to the *Votes and Proceedings*,

“Mr Speaker further *directed* that the written answers to the Question be transmitted to the Hon Member.”

However, when you come to page 13, the item numbered 146, you directed that the Question posed by Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (Oforikrom) be deemed as asked and duly answered, but there is no indication that the written Answers be transmitted to the Hon Member. Same flows to page 14 under Elvis Osei—

11.08 a.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are right. Table Office, take note.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: I am most grateful, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 14...16?

Yes?

Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Page 16, the item numbered 14(b) (ii), Mr Speaker, you referred that statement to the Committee on Education, but I think the Ghana School of Law is under the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs. This is just to draw your attention. *[Pause]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you are right. Because all these Papers were laid by the Minister for Education, we referred them to the Committee on Education. But having drawn my attention to it, I think it is proper to refer the item to the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs. So accordingly, the Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana School of Law for the year 2024 is accordingly referred to the Constitutional and Legal Committee for consideration and report.

Page 17?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. In all humility, I bring your attention to the last paragraph. During the Consideration Stage of the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, 2025 yesterday, Mr Speaker, you were fully in charge, and I recall that you gave the directive to the draftsman. But over here, the data captures it as the Hon Second Deputy Speaker giving the directive. So, in all humility, if the Table will take note and correct it.

Again, Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, the item numbered 15(2)

“Clause 4”. The Chairman of the Committee for the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, proposed an amendment for the inclusion of the “Student Loan Trust Fund”. If the Chairman or the Clerks-at the-Table could help, is it really “Student Loan Trust Fund” or “Students Loan Trust Fund”? If it is the plural version, then I suggest that “s” be added to the word “Student” so that it is captured as “Students”.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, kindly crosscheck. On the first issue, you are right. So, it is the Hon First Deputy Speaker.

Thank you very much, Hon Member.

Page 18?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, consequentially, the same correction should be done on page 18.

Then at the ending part of page 18, Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe has been captured as the “Second Deputy Majority Whip”. She is rather the Hon First Deputy Majority Whip, so the record should be amended accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table Office, kindly crosscheck consequentially, “Hon Second Deputy Speaker”, instead of the “Hon First Deputy Speaker”. The proper rendition should be “The Hon First Deputy

Speaker”. Yes. He is correct in doing that, but at the same page, “Hon Second Deputy Speaker appears instead of the “Hon First Deputy Speaker”. So, the consequential correction should also be done.

Page 19 ...22?

Yes?

Mr Francis Kwabena Berepong Owusu-Akyaw: Thank you, Mr Speaker. On page 22, Committee on Education, the opening time is “1.30 p.m.” and when we look at the closing time, it is the same thing, “1.30 p.m.”. So, Table Office should check.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what is the closing time that you are referring to?

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: Mr Speaker, page 22, Committee on Education.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: When we check the opening time, it is “1.30 p.m.” and then when we come to item number 4, Closing, the meeting ended at 1.30 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it on the same page? Hon Member, refer to the appropriate pages. You said page 22. On Page 22, we can see “The Committee met on Monday, 14th July, 2025, at 1.30 p.m.”. Is anything wrong on page 22?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Yes, Mr Speaker. I think in the *Votes and Proceedings* he has, when he gets to page 23—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 23?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Yes. There is a closing time of “1.30 p.m.”, which is an error.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, that is why I am asking whether the correction is on page 22 or page 23.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: The correction is supposed to be on page 23.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes. Table Office, page 23, take note. *[Pause]*

Hon Member, are you holding a different document? On the document that we have, the commencement time is at page 22, “1.30 p.m.”. Then when you go to page 24, the closing time is 3.00 p.m. Is the *Votes and Proceedings* right, or the document that you are holding is causing the confusion? Are we holding one and the same *Votes and Proceedings*?

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: No, Mr Speaker, because what I have here is different from what I have received as new. The Clerk-to-Parliament has checked and has seen that it is right.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What is the date of your *Votes and Proceedings*? Is it Thursday, 17th July, 2025?

Mr Owusu-Akyaw: Yes, Mr Speaker.

11.18 a.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clerks, how can we have two different *Votes and Proceedings*?

[Pause]

Is any other Member having the wrong *Votes and Proceedings*? You also have the same wrong *Votes and Proceedings*. Hon Members, I am told it is the printer's error because the same page has been repeated in some of the *Votes and Proceedings*. Otherwise, whatever is captured on page 22 is correct and the time captured on page 24 is also correct. Table Office, kindly take note so that the apparent errors in the *Votes and Proceedings* will be avoided.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know. The Clerks-at-the-Table, it is just those in the Minority that have the wrong *Votes and Proceedings*. Mr Speaker, I do not get it. Is it the case that Hon Acheampong directed that we should be given the wrong *Votes and Proceedings* or what? Because it is just our Side that has the wrong ones. So, the Clerks-at-the-Table, next time, double-check everything—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Whip, I think you are completely out of order. Hon Acheampong is not responsible for printing *Votes and Proceedings*. Hon Acheampong, will you still speak when I indicated that you are not responsible for printing *Votes and Proceedings*?

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, you are right, but I take a serious exception to what my Colleague just said. Mr Speaker, by the way they walked out from the Chamber. How would you hear what I said when they walk out? [Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, page 23...24.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 17th July, 2025 as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, we have two *Official Reports*; Friday, 11th July, 2025 and Saturday, 12th July, 2025. We shall first consider Friday, 11th July, 2025.

Hon Members, any correction? —
[Pause]

[No correction was made to the *Official Report of Friday, 11th July, 2025*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the *Official Report* of Saturday, 12th July, 2025, for your correction?

Hon Members, any correction? —
[Pause]

[No correction was made to the
Official Report of Saturday, 12th July,
2025]

Hon Members, the next item is the
item numbered 6 on page 2 of today's
Order Paper—Presentation of Business
Statement for the 9th Week. I will then call
upon the Chairman of the Business
Committee to present the Business
Statement.

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers and the Governor of the Bank of Ghana to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

	<u>No. of Question(s)</u>
i. Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry	4
ii. Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development	8
iii. Minister for Defence	2
iv. Governor of the Bank of Ghana	1
v. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
vi. Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment	1

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

**Chairman of the Business
Committee/Majority Leader (Mr
Mahama Ayariga):** Mr Speaker, your
Committee met yesterday, Thursday,
17th July, 2025, and arranged Business of
the House for the ninth week ending
Friday, 25th July, 2025.

The Committee Report is presented
subject to some amendments that I will
indicate as I go along.

vii. Minister for Transport	3
viii. Minister for Health	8
ix. Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	2
Total Number of Questions	<u>39</u>

Mr Speaker, in all, 8 Ministers and the Governor of the Bank of Ghana are expected to attend upon the House to respond to 39 Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 3; ii. Oral – 36

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the Week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Referral at Committees

Mr Speaker, as was published in the Business Statement of the eighth week presented last week, an updated breakdown of Committees and pending referrals has been attached for the attention of leadership of the respective Committees to guide the consideration and reporting on the referrals. In all, 112 referrals have been assigned to 19 Committees for consideration and report to the House.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee continuous to urge all Committees to prioritise consideration of the referrals in accordance with Order 267(4).

Enforcement of the Provisions of the Standing Orders on Question Time and Time Allowed for Statements

Mr Speaker, in order to streamline the conduct of Business and to manage the number of hours Hon Members

spend in this House on any given Sitting day, the Business Committee proposes a strict enforcement of Order 72(2).

In view of that, the Committee suggests that Question time should strictly be within an hour, hence, not more than 10 Questions would be scheduled for each Sitting day. This translates into an average of 6 minutes per Question. The Committee proposes that Hon Members will be limited to ask two substantive Questions within a week.

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee also proposes that Statements time,

pursuant to Order 94, be limited to an hour. No more than three Statements shall be read by Hon Members in a Sitting day, each within five minutes, and a comment by an Hon Member shall not exceed three minutes.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216(2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the Week.

LIST OF REFERRALS PENDING

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
1.	Finance Committee (7 Referrals)	1. Annual Public Debt Management Report for the 2024 Financial Year. 2. Annual Report on the Management of the Energy Sector Levies and Accounts for the Year 2024. 3. Annual Report on Public Private Partnership Projects for the year 2024. 4. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Ministry of Finance for the Period January to December, 2024. 5. Report of the Finance Committee on the Ghana Cocoa Board (Amendment) Bill, 2025. 6. Ghana Deposit Protection (Amendment) Bill, 2025. 7. Annual Report on the Petroleum Funds for the 2024 Fiscal Year.
2.	Public Accounts Committee (17 Referrals)	1. Follow-up Report of the Auditor-General on the Three Performance Audits in respect of: Regulating Small-Scale Mining for a Sustainable Environment; Sustainability of Sports Stadia in Ghana; and Administration of Scholarships by the GETFund. 2. Report of the Auditor-General on the Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Half-Year Ended 30th June, 2024. 3. Special Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the recoveries made from disallowed expenditure in the Auditor-General's Reports from 2020 to 2023 and payroll savings as at 31st December, 2024. 4. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana: Public Boards, Corporations and other Statutory Institutions for the Period Ended 31st December, 2024. 5. Report of the Auditor-General on the Accounts of District Assemblies for the Financial Year ended 31st December, 2024. 6. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Availability of Fertilisers to Small Holder Farmers in Ghana. 7. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Provision and Maintenance of Toilet Facilities in Public Schools.

AT COMMITTEES

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		8. Report of the Auditor-General on the Management and Utilisation of the District Assemblies' Common Fund (DACF) and Other Statutory Funds for the year ended 31st December, 2024. 9. Report of the Auditor-General on the Management of Petroleum Funds for the Period January to December 2024. 10. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana – Public Universities and Colleges of Education for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024. 11. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana - Ministries, Departments and Other Agencies for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024. 12. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Utilisation of GNPC's Share of the Petroleum Revenue on Infrastructure Projects. 13. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on Computerised Financial and Electronic Systems in Selected Covered Entities as at 31st December, 2024. 14. Performance Audit Report of the Auditor-General on the Procurement and Management of Medical Equipment in Teaching Hospitals. 15. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana (Whole-of-Government Accounts) for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024. 16. Report of the Auditor-General on the Consolidated Statements of Foreign Exchange Receipts and Payments of the Bank of Ghana (BoG) for the Year Ended 31st December, 2024. 17. Report of the Auditor-General on the Public Accounts of Ghana, Pre- University Educational Institutions for the Financial Year Ended 31st December, 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
3.	Committee on Local Government and Rural Development (30 Referral)	1. Annual report of the District Assemblies Common Fund for the year 2023. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Births and Deaths Registry for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman North District Assembly for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi Nchumuru District Assembly for the year 2024. 7. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atiwa West District Assembly for the year 2024. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mampong Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 10. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jasikan Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 11. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Juaboso District Assembly for the year 2024. 12. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the La Nkwantanang- Madina Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 13. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Berekum Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 14. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		15. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 16. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Local Government, Decentralisation and Rural Development for the year 2024. 17. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 18. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mion District Assembly for the year 2024. 19. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kadjebi District Assembly for the year 2024. 20. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ningo-Prampram District Assembly for the year 2024. 21. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Pru West District Assembly for the year 2024. 22. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 23. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ledzokuku Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 24. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 25. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema Metropolitan Assembly for the year 2024. 26. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 27. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Biakoye District Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
3.	Committee on Local Government and Rural Development (30 Referral)	28. Annual report of the District Assemblies Common Fund for the year 2023. 29. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Births and Deaths Registry for the year 2024. 30. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 31. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman North District Assembly for the year 2024. 32. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 33. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Krachi Nchumuru District Assembly for the year 2024. 34. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atiwa West District Assembly for the year 2024. 35. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 36. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mampong Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 37. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jasikan Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 38. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Juaboso District Assembly for the year 2024. 39. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the La Nkwantanang- Madina Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 40. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Berekum Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 41. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		42. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 43. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Local Government, Decentralisation and Rural Development for the year 2024. 44. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 45. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mion District Assembly for the year 2024. 46. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kadjebi District Assembly for the year 2024. 47. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ningo-Prampram District Assembly for the year 2024. 48. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Pru West District Assembly for the year 2024. 49. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Jaman South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 50. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ledzokuku Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 51. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 52. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tema Metropolitan Assembly for the year 2024. 53. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu-Amantin Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 54. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Biakoye District Assembly for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		55. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Fanteakwa North District Assembly for the year 2024. 56. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the New Juaben North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024. 57. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Yilo Krobo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
4.	Committee on Public Administration and State Interests (6 Referrals)	1. Annual Report on the Staffing Position of the Office of the President for the Period 1st January to 31st December 2024. 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Head of the Civil Service for the Period January to December, 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the President for the year 2024. 4. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the Head of Civil Service for the year 2024. 6. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Office of the President for the year 2024.
5.	Committee on Independent Constitutional Bodies (4 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Audit Service for the Period January to December, 2024. 2. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the National Commission for Civic Education for the Period January to December, 2024. 3. Budget Performance Report in respect of Office of the Electoral Commission for the Period January to December, 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Commission for Civic Education for the year 2024.
6.	Committee on Lands and Natural Resources (3 Referrals)	1. Annual Report of the Forestry Commission for the Year 2022. 2. Budget Performance Report in Respect of the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources for the Period January to December, 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Land Use and Spatial Planning Authority (LUSPA) for the year 2024.
7.	Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs (3 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Office of the Attorney- General and Ministry of Justice for the Period January to December, 2024. 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Office of the Special Prosecutor for the Period January to December, 2024. 3. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Legal Aid Commission for the Period January to December, 2024.
8.	Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs (1 Referral)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development for the Period January to December, 2024.
9.	Committee on Youth and Sports (2 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Youth and Sports for the Period January to December, 2024. 2. Report on the 13 th African Games, Accra 2023, hosted by Ghana from 3 rd - 23 rd March, 2024.
10.	Committee on Works and Housing (1 Referral)	Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Works and Housing for the Period January to December, 2024.
11.	Committee on Roads and Transportation (3 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Transport for the Period January to December, 2024. 2. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Railway Development for the Period January to December, 2024. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta Lake Transport Company Limited for the year 2024.
12.	Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism (2 Referrals)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Trade and Industry for the Period January to December, 2024. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
13.	Committee on Employment, Labour Relations and Pensions (1 Referral)	1. Budget Performance Report in respect of the Ministry of Employment and Labour Relations for the Period January to December, 2024.
14.	Committee on Education (17 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian College of Education, Akropong-Akuapem for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Communication Technology University for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nusrat Jahan Ahmadiyya College of Education for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mount Mary College of Education, Somanya, for the year 2024. 5. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) for the year 2024. 6. University for Development Studies Bill, 2025. 7. Ghana Scholarships Authority Bill, 2025. 8. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Koforidua Technical University for the year 2024. 9. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the OLA College of Education, Cape Coast, for the year 2024. 10. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Accra Technical University for the year 2024. 11. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kumasi Technical University for the year 2024. 12. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ada College of Education for the year 2024. 13. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Presbyterian Women's College of Education, Aburi, for the year 2024. 14. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Complementary Education Agency for the year 2024. 15. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Education, Winneba, for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
		16. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atebubu College of Education for the year 2024. 17. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University for Development Studies for the year 2024.
15.	Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare (1 Referral)	1. Social Welfare on the Social Protection Bill, 2025.
16.	Committee on Subsidiary Legislation (6 Referrals)	1. Environmental Protection (Refrigeration and Air Conditioning Certification) Regulations, 2025. 2. Environmental Protection (Environmental Assessment) Regulations, 2025. 3. Environmental Protection (Management of Ozone Depleting Substances, Halocarbons, Halocarbon Alternatives and their Products) Regulations, 2025. 4. Environmental Protection (Effluent) Regulations, 2025. 5. Environmental Protection (Air Quality Management) Regulations, 2025 6. Environmental Protection (Petroleum) Regulations, 2025
17.	Committee on Health (3 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Ghana Medical Centre for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Food and Drug Authority for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of Nurses' Training College, Pantang for the year 2024.
18.	Committee on Energy (4 Referrals)	1. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Petroleum Authority for the year 2024. 2. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Volta River Authority for the year 2024. 3. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Bui Power Authority for the year 2024. 4. Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Petroleum Hub Development Corporation for the year 2024.

No.	COMMITTEE	REFERRALS
19.	Committee on Constitutional and legal Affairs (1 Referral)	Annual Report of the Right to Information Commission for the year 2024.

Monday, 21st July, 2025

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Questions

Presentation of Papers

(a) 2024 Annual National Progress Report of the National Development Planning Commission on the Implementation of the Medium-Term National Development Plan Under the Policy Framework (An Agenda for Jobs II: Creating Prosperity and Equal Opportunity for All - 2022-2025).

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ga East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ashanti Regional Co-ordinating Council for the year 2024.

(c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre South District Assembly for the year 2024.

(d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Afigya Kwabre North District Assembly for the year 2024.

(e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sefwi Akontombra District Assembly for the year 2024.

(f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Okere District Assembly for the year 2024.

(h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Shama District Assembly for the year 2024.

(i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie Central District Assembly for the year 2024.

(j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie South District Assembly for the year 2024.

(k) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kwadaso Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(l) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asunafo North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(m) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Adansi North District Assembly for the year 2024.

(n) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Nkoranza North District Assembly for the year 2024.

- (o) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Old Tafo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (p) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Agona West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (q) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Tano South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (r) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sekyere East District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (s) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Lower Manya Krobo Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (t) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Birim North District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (u) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ayawaso East Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (v) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Keta Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (w) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Architectural and Engineering Services Limited for the year 2024.

- (x) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the State Interests and Governance Authority for the year 2024.
- (y) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Grid Company Limited for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sitings

Tuesday, 22nd July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Questions

***286. Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the Komenda Sugar Factory.

***315. Mr Michael Okyere Baafi (New Juaben South):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the status of the vehicle component manufacturing policy.

***316. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the specific interventions the Ministry has taken to stimulate domestic production, increase export volumes and add value to our products to boost trade earnings.

***401. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang – Lower Denkyira):** To ask the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry the plans of the Ministry to increase exports to take advantage of the current cedi performance as well as increase the share of the trade sector to Ghana's GDP.

***345. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the steps being taken to operationalise the One-Stop-Shop Aquaculture Licensing System in 2025, and how this reform will improve regulatory compliance and investment in the aquaculture industry.

***347. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta (Fanteakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development when the proposed Blue-Economy Commission will be established and what legal or institutional framework will guide its operations.

***354. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development when the Anomabo Fisheries College will be fully operationalised and what Academic Programmes will be introduced for the first cohort in the 2025/2026 academic year.

***355. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the measures

the Ministry has taken to ensure the timely completion of the outstanding components of the Anomabo Fisheries College infrastructure.

***358. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the steps the Ministry has taken to intensify biosecurity protocols in aquaculture, including fish disease detection training, quality assurance and improved fish genetics.

***359. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the support packages being offered under the Aqua/Cage-Culture Project to women and youth groups and how equitable access to these inputs will be ensured across Districts.

***360 Mr Rudolf Amoako-Gyampah (Upper Denkyira West):** To ask the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development the status of the 157 Premix Fuel Automation outlets under construction as of the end of 2024 and the steps the Ministry is taking to ensure the completion of the remaining 143 outlets in 2025.

Presentation of Papers

(a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana National Fire Service for the year 2024.

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Prisons Service for the year 2024.

- (c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gaming Commission of Ghana for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sittings

Wednesday, 23rd July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Urgent Questions

- (d) **Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh (Bosome Freho):** To ask the Minister for Defence what measures the Ministry is taking to ensure the territorial integrity, security of Officers and Citizens of Ghana in the mist of the recent political instability in Togo.

- (e) **Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Governor of the Bank of Ghana the state of affairs regarding the close to hundred (100) employees who endured distress following the termination of their employment.

Questions

- *350. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso):** To ask the Minister for Defence how the Ministry plans to maintain professionalism in the Armed Forces of Ghana and enhance its capacity in protecting our territorial integrity and sustaining our democracy.

- *274. Dr Gideon Boako (Tano North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the progress of works on the following road projects: (i) Bomaa – Tepa (ii) Bomaa – Duayaw Nkwanta (iii) Bomaa – Jamfo and Yamfo town roads and (iv) Bomaa Town roads.

- *275. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of upgrading the following roads in the Constituency: (i) Pakyi – Antoakrom feeder roads (ii) Nweneso No. 1 and Trabuom by-pass (iii) Pakyi No. 1 – Pakyi No. 2 road (iv) Anwiankwanta – Manso Nkwanta road.

- *276. Mr Richard Kuuire (Nandom):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor will return to site to complete the construction of the Kambaa Bridge which was abandoned on October 2024.

- *287. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads in the Suhum Constituency will be completed: (i) Amanhyia (ii) Akorabo to Nankese (iii) Suhum to Ateibu (iv) Ali-Tetekasu to Dokrochiwa (v) Krobom to Korkortasu (vi) Esaase to Aponoapono and Supresu to Obuotumpan.

- *288. Mr Mohammed Adams Sukparu (Sissala West):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the road construction from Gbal through Zini to Han.

***289. Mr Mohammed Adams Sukparu (Sissala West):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the road construction from Gwollu to Jeffisi.

***290. Mr Mohammed Adams Sukparu (Sissala West):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of construction of the Gwollu town roads.

***291. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the timelines for the completion of the rehabilitation and dualisation of the Accra to Kumasi Highway between Ofankor and Nkawkaw.

***292. Mr Richard Kuuire (Nandom):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the steps being taken to commence the construction of the Nandom-Ko-Dowini road.

***293. Mr William Ntebe (Tatale-Sanguli):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways to provide an update on the status of the following roads in the Tatale-Sanguli constituency: (i) Sheini to Kpajaba (ii) Zabzugu to Sheini and (iii) Zabzugu to Koryili.

***352. Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (Yendi):** To ask the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment the plans of the government to complete the Yendi Youth Resource Centre which is also known as the Yendi Stadium.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Chartered Institute of Bankers, Ghana for the year 2024.
- (b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the McCoy College of Education for the year 2024.
- (c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Enchi College of Education for the year 2024.
- (d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the SDA College of Education, Asokore, Koforidua for the year 2024.
- (e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the E.P. College of Education, Bimbilla for the year 2024.
- (f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Abetifi Presbyterian College of Education for the year 2024.
- (g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Media Arts and Communication for the year 2024.
- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Wiawso College of Education for the year 2024.
- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St. Louis College of Education for the year 2024.

- (j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Komenda College of Education for the year 2024.
- (k) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Schools Inspectorate Authority for the year 2024.
- (l) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akrokerri College of Education for the year 2024.
- (m) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Takoradi Technical University for the year 2024.
- (n) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Science Association for the year 2024.
- (o) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ho Technical University for the year 2024.
- (p) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Peki College of Education for the year 2024.
- (q) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Health and Allied sciences for the year 2024.
- (r) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the St Francis College of Education for the year 2024.
- (s) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the University of Mines and Energy for the year 2024.
- (t) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mampong

Technical College of Education for the year 2024.

- (u) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Students Loan Trust Fund for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sittings

Thursday, 24th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

- Mid-Year Review of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2025 Financial Year.

Urgent Questions

Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (Pru East): To ask the Minister for Transport immediate steps the Ministry is taking to increase the number of ferries operating between Yeji and Makango, given the overwhelming demand and pressure on the existing single ferry.

Questions

***321. Mr Francis Asenso Boakye (Bantama):** To ask the Minister for Transport what specific measures the Ministry is implementing to revitalise the Metro Mass Transit system at Abrepo Junction to improve efficiency, enhance commuters' accessibility in the Ashanti region and create employment opportunities for the local economy.

***322. Mr John Darko (Suame):** To ask the Minister for Transport to provide an update on the proposal of government to set up a national airline.

Presentation of Papers

(a) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Atomic Energy Commission for the year 2024.

(b) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Environment, Science and Technology for the year 2024.

(c) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Environmental Protection Authority for the year 2024.

(d) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Security and Exchange Commission for the year 2024.

(e) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Information Technology Authority for the year 2024.

(f) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Data Protection Commission for the year 2024.

(g) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cyber Security Authority for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sittings

Friday, 25th July, 2025

Roll Call

Statements

Questions

***85. Dr Kingsley Agyemang (Abuakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Health the novel perspective of the Ministry on preventive medicine giving the high and rising burden of non-communicable diseases.

***86. Dr Kingsley Agyemang (Abuakwa South):** To ask the Minister for Health what approach the Ministry is taking to coordinate data collection, analysis and dissemination of research to generate evidence-based health policies.

***112. Mr Pious Kwame Nkuah (Sefwi-Akontombra):** To ask the Minister for Health why the Sefwi Akontonbra District Hospital, which was initially proposed to be 46 bed capacity, was reduced to 26 bed capacity after completion.

***127. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister for Health to provide a detailed report on the current state of the construction of the maternity ward at the Tafo Government Hospital, including when it is expected to be completed and to indicate if the government has plans to ensure its prompt completion.

***250. Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissue (Ahanta West):** To ask the Minister for Health the current status of the Agenda 111 hospital project at Bokoro in the Ahanta West Constituency which was commissioned in an uncompleted state by former President Nana Adoo Dankwa Akufo-Addo and when is it expected to be fully completed and operational.

***251. Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissue (Ahanta West):** To ask the Minister for Health the status of the Western Regional Hospital project at Apemanim which was awarded to Amandi contruction under the NPP government and the measures being taken to commence the project and ensure its timely completion.

***262. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum):** To ask the Minister for Health the plans of the Ministry for the expansion and refurbishment of the emergency ward of the Suhum Government Hospital.

***263. Mr Nana Osei-Adjei (New Juaben North):** To ask the Minister for Health the status of the Eastern Regional Hospital which has been abandoned after 70% completion.

***279. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the measures being put in place to prevent the desecration of the Independence Arch, Kwame Nkrumah Mausoleum and other notable national monuments by same-sex couples and LBGT activists as was seen in June 2025.

***367. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South):** To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the measures the Ministry is implementing to prevent the desecration of the Independence Arc, Kwame Nkrumah Mausoleum and other sacred national monuments by same-sex couples and LGBTQ+ activists.

Presentation of Papers

- (h) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Mental Health Authority for the year 2024.
- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana AIDS Commission for the year 2024.
- (j) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Tourism Authority for the year 2024.
- (k) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akuapem North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (l) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akuapim South Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.
- (m) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atiwa East District Assembly for the year 2024.
- (n) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Amansie West District Assembly for the year 2024.

(o) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Atwima Nwabiagya North District Assembly for the year 2024.

(p) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asante Akim North Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(q) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Cape Coast Metropolitan Assembly for the year 2024.

(r) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ablekuma Central Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(s) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kwahu West Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(t) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Asene Manso Akroso District Assembly for the year 2024.

(u) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Korle-Klottey Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(v) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Sagnarigu Municipal Assembly for the year 2024.

(w) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Gomoa West District Assembly for the year 2024.

(x) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Akrofuom District Assembly for the year 2024.

Motions

Committee Sitzings

11.28 a.m.

Mr Speaker, I have indicated earlier that, for the Urgent Question numbered 3(b) slated for Wednesday, 23rd July, 2025, the Governor of the Bank of Ghana is unable to come that day. I would discuss the appropriate day with the Hon Member who asked the Question, so that we can look at when that can happen.

Mr Speaker. I urge the House to adopt the Report of the Business Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, Business Committee duly presented by the Chairman of the Business Committee; it is now for your comment.

Yes, Hon Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, on page 8 of the Business Statement, the item numbered 127, I see that a Question that I filed and the Minister actually appeared before this House and answered has reappeared in the Business Statement, so I will crave the indulgence of the Table Office to eliminate the Question from the Statement—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very Well, Chairman of the Committee, take note.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, unless, of course, the Table Office believes that the Question was not answered properly, which I also believe anyway, and secondly, I mentioned the item number 127—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee, a Question asked and answered has been repeated. So, the Table Office should take note in order not to programme that Question again.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, on page 4, I see the Minister for Defence appear before the House on Wednesday. I have filed two Urgent Questions to the Minister for Defence last week and I am expecting that it should be here. I will crave the indulgence of the Table Office and the Business Committee to reconsider those two Urgent Questions that have been filed by me to see if the Minister for Defence can answer them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know that a Question filed must be admitted first.

Mr Assafuah: I agree, that is why I am craving the indulgence of the Table Office—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Has your Question passed the admission test?

Mr Assafuah: Well, I am sure that if the admissibility test has been passed—

11.38 a.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Rt Hon Speaker indicated that I would be

responsible for the admission of Questions, but I have not seen your Question for admission.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, these are Questions that I filed about two weeks ago; the Table Office can confirm this. I am just craving your indulgence—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Where did you file it?

Mr Assafuah: With the Table Office and they can confirm it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, follow up and ensure that they have brought it to my attention for admission first.

Mr Assafuah: Very well.

Mr Speaker, at page 2 of the Business Statement, with respect to the time that has been allotted for Questions, I know you have been in this House for so long and I am just five years in this House, but it is becoming strange for me to see how times have been allotted for Questions. This is because I do not see how a whole Hon Minister will be brought to this House to answer Questions that are of public importance or public interest and we find the Hon Minister living here after five or 10 minutes. Even the one who is asking the substantive Question is given one additional question to ask. It happened to me last week. For the five years that I have been in this House, it is strange to me and I think that that is the only way the oversight responsibility can be played.

Mr Speaker, I will crave the indulgence of the Business Committee to relook at this very well for us. This is because if we look at it very well, with how it has been couched, I do not know if the three minutes that will be given for additional questions will be for the one who asked the substantive Question or any other Member could also benefit from those three minutes.

Mr Speaker, I am pleading that that is the only time we can play that oversight responsibility and some attention should be given to it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, in the best practices all over the jurisdiction, Questions are asked within a minute and Answers to the Question do not take more than two minutes. So, if you have a Question to ask, how elaborate is your Question, such that a Question captured in the Order Paper which you would have to read, would take you more than a minute to read?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, no, I am talking about follow-up questions. Three minutes have been allotted. As for the three minutes, I do not know whether it will be given to the one who asked the substantive Question. I want clarification.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you listened to the reading of the Business Statement carefully, it even requested for the indulgence of the House to limit follow-up Questions to the questioner. That answers your question. If agreed upon by the House, that answers your question.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, that is why I said, I have been in this House for five years; this is new. That a whole Minister will come to this House and the one asking a substantive Question is the only person who can ask the Minister a Question. Especially, when the one who asked the substantive Question has been given only one additional question to ask, how are we going to do justice to the Questions?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Assafuah, what does the Rules say about supplementary questions?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I am saying that when—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What does the Rules say about supplementary questions?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I am quoting the Rule for you. In fact, when you read the Business Statement, the Rules have been stated. It was the preliminary comments that came from the Business Statement. It is a plea. We are here to play an oversight responsibility. Many a time, you hardly see Members of Parliament who belong to the Government asking Questions. That is the only time that Members who are in opposition can play that oversight responsibility.

Mr Speaker, so, I am pleading that we should have a relook at it, respectfully.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I asked, respectfully, what the

Rules say. If you look at Order 89(2), it reads:

“The Member who asked a Question may be allowed to ask not more than three Supplementary Questions on the substantive Question.”

So, the “The Member may be allowed...”. There are instances where due to the exigencies of time, the Member may not be allowed to ask three supplementary questions. The time is to guide us. If instead of asking a supplementary question, you choose to make a statement, you are eating into your own time. If you choose to violate Order 88(7), you are eating into your own time. So, the Business Statement, as presented, is within our Rules.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, I disagree. These are two different things. You are saying that the person who is asking the Question may be given three additional questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are talking about any other Member. Now, that goes to Order 89(3).

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, respectfully—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Listen to Order 89(3) first:

“Any other Member may be allowed to ask not more than two Supplementary Questions...”.

So, the other Member “may be allowed”. That is why the Business Statement is seeking the indulgence of the House to limit supplementary questions to the questioner. If the House agrees on it, it is perfectly within the Rules.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I just want to draw the attention of the Hon Member that any time the Speaker is speaking, a Member is supposed to resume his seat and listen to the Speaker. When the Speaker finishes, then the Member will try to catch his eye again, then they can speak. If a Member does not catch the eye of the Speaker, even when he or she gets up again or they rise again in their seat, it does not give them an automatic right to just start speaking.

So, I am pleading. We have first-timers who have just come. They are watching us, so, we, the seniors, who have been here for five years, let us do what is right so that the first-timers can learn from us.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Majority Leader. Yes, Hon Member, you are still not clear?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, no, please.

Mr Speaker, what you read and what has been stated in the Business Statement are two different things. The Order that you read says that “the Member may be given three additional questions”. What the Business Statement is now saying is that we will be given three minutes.

Within those three minutes, how do I ask three follow-up questions and the Minister will also Answer those Questions within these three minutes?

The Order also says that “any other Member may be given two additional questions”. I am only saying, Mr Speaker, that the only time this Side of the House can play that oversight responsibility is to bring the Ministers here. So, let us have a relook at the number of minutes that have been allotted for Question time. This is because last week, it happened to me. I brought a whole Minister here to ask a constituency-specific Question and I was given only one follow-up question which did not do justice to why I brought the Minister here.

Mr Speaker, so, I am pleading with you that let us have a relook at it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, based on the exigencies of time, whoever is presiding may exercise the discretion given by Order 89 to even disallow a supplementary question. We need to read in between the lines of the Standing Orders. It is not an automatic right, cast in stone, that you are entitled to ask three supplementary questions. You may be allowed, that is the language used in the Standing Orders. I believe it is very loud and clear. When you are given the opportunity to ask one supplementary question, it is not in violation of our Standing Orders.

Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I want to commend the Leader of the House for delivering the Business Statement for next week.

Mr Speaker, if I say I am happy this morning, it will be a lie. It seems we are being gagged in this House not to ask Questions; that is completely unfair. Having being in this House for four years and about six months, in the Eighth Parliament, Questions were asked and supplementary questions were asked unabated.

11.48 p.m.

What has changed? I strongly disagree with this proposition; it is unfair. It is not helping parliamentary democracy.

Questions are supposed to be asked to get information but now, he is saying that nobody will be allowed to ask a supplementary question. What is this? Mr Speaker, we are building a democracy. Our Friends on the other Side have been blessed to have this superior Majority. — *[Expunged by order of Mr Speaker.]* They should not do that.

This is completely an attempt to cow us from exercising effective oversight over the Executive. Mr Speaker, we respect Hon Ayariga a lot. This week he has been bringing this matter up—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, let me find out from you whether the Business Committee is made up of only the Majority.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, he chairs it. In our Standing Orders, Order 55 talks about commencement and adjournment of Sitting, that we should ordinarily sit for five hours. But in Order 56, three minutes before that time, a Member can rise and make a case for it to be extended. It is clear in our Rules; the same applies to Order 77 as you quoted. Now, this restriction is not going to help us to build the capacity of Members and to ensure that this democracy is strengthened. We should not do that, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, we should prepare as Members of Parliament to be held responsible for words that we use on the floor of the House. You said they are — and I asked a question. Is the Business Committee made up of only the Majority Members of the House? So, I am guiding you to be measured in the language that you use.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with all due respect, I have not offended Order 123(2) of our Standing Orders. I have not insulted anybody; I am just saying that they are — Please, is it offensive? No, because of the new rules and these rules violate our Orders. These rules affront our orders. These rules that today, our Leader has brought to fore offend our Orders.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, if a Committee's Report is here and the Report is being discussed, would that amount to —? Because this is a Report of the Business Committee, not a report of the Majority Side.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, I am not part of the Committee, but the Report has been read to us and I am saying that it is completely a no-no. We should reconsider this position, because I can ask a question—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I do not have a problem with your suggestion to reconsider the decision of the Business Committee. I am talking with specific reference of your statement that it amounts to —. Now, Parliament is live.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am saying that the exercise of the Majority numbers in this manner is not right. It is not right, Mr Speaker. I have made my point and I am saying that I will be happy—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, look at the Business Statement and tell me whether it is a Majority decision or a Minority decision.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am not disputing that, but I also have the right to raise issues of concern.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You have a right to raise issues. I am taking you on the use of your words — Do you still stand that you have a justification to say that based on the Business Statement, without an indication whether the Business Statement is Majority decision or Minority decision, you are justified in stating that the presentation of this Business Statement amounts to?—

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, if you listen to me carefully, I said that from

what has transpired this week, the spirit and the intent, the spirit and the letter of what has been captured today and read to us amounts to that. That is my respective opinion on the matter.

Mr Speaker, last two weeks—*[Interruption]*—I have made my point already.

Mr Speaker, my second issue is—because I made a point that our Leadership should look at the issue because it is unfair.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, I recognise Hon Richard Acheampong.

Mr Richard Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I heard my Colleague say that he is not a member of the Business Committee. So, for his information, let me read to him the Members who attended yesterday's Business Committee meeting.

The first person is Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan; Richard Acheampong; Mohammed Adamu Ramadan; Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah; Mr Kofi Benteh Afful; Prof Hamza Adam, Mr Fred Kwesi Agbenyo; Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh; Dr Yaw Osei Adutwum; Mrs Mavis Nkansah-Boadu. They took this very decision for the consideration of the House.

So he cannot conclude that the Majority is using its numbers to gag any Member from asking questions. He was not there, so I am providing information for him so that he can continue.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, you have guided us with regard to what the Business Committee Chairman presented.

Mr Speaker, except that, it does not lie on the Business Committee or the Chairman of the Business Committee to tell us that we should take Questions within one minute or two minutes. But your interpretation of Order 88(2), I agree with you that if we do the combined effect of what is in Order 89(2)—Mr Speaker, I read Order 89(2):

“The Member who asked a Question may be allowed to ask not more than three Supplementary Questions on the substantive Question.”

Based on your guidance, it means that the Member has up to three supplementary questions. So it could be one, two or three. Mr Speaker, on that, I agree but looking at our Orders, the interpretation and how the Orders are supposed to work, Order 5 is clear.

Mr Speaker, I will read Order 5, which states that,

“Subject to the provisions of the Constitution and any other enactment, where there is doubt, these Orders shall be interpreted by Mr Speaker.”

So, Mr Speaker, as many as may say that supplementary questions should be three; it is up to you, at the time they are asking the Questions, for you, the person presiding, to give that directive and not the Business Committee or the Chairman of the Business Committee to take a

decision and bring it to this House to the effect that Members should ask one supplementary question.

So Mr Speaker, with respect, we agree that it should be up to three, but it does not lie on the Majority Leader. You know, these days, Majority Leader, with his numbers, always—

Mr Speaker, the Leader of the Deputy Minister is on his feet and he want to interject me. So, he should sit down and let me finish.

So Mr Speaker, with respect, we agree on your interpretation, but per our Standing Orders, you are the right person to interpret that, but not the Chairman of the Business Committee to come and tell us. That is not part of their work.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, as indicated, Parliament is now live; the general public is looking at us. We all know the composition of the Business Committee.

11.58 a.m.

Now, it is the Business Committee's Report that is being presented to us. My only issue in relation to which I am guiding the Hon Member for Kwadaso is that, having regard to the composition of the Business Committee and the fact that this is a Committee's Report, recommending to the House that we do "A, B, C, D", and the House is commenting on it—This is the issue. Else, I would not have uttered any words but listened to his comments in totality. So, the impression being created out

there as if the Business Statement is emanating from only the Majority Side is what I am trying to correct.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with respect, yes, I am a member of the Business Committee and yes, I attended yesterday's meeting. Mr Speaker, may I invite you to Order 216 and I anchor my points or my submission specifically on (2) (b). Mr Speaker, with your leave, I read:

(2) Subject to Order 67, the Committee shall

(b) recommend the time allotted for debate on Bills, Motions, Private Member's Bills, Private Member's Motions, and other business;

So, Hon Colleagues, I may have my dissenting views, but it is within the rights of the Business Committee to make this proposal and this proposal is before the House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: For adoption or otherwise. Yes. So, I do not think this is a matter we should split our heads on—*[Interruption]*—Well, that is his view. I cannot go against him with his view. He has the right to express same. So, let us listen to views, and then Plenary will take a decision whether to adopt or not to adopt.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I think we are speaking the same language.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it is as simple as that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: My view is that whatever the Business Committee has done, it is within the powers of the Business Committee to make those recommendations to the House. It is now left for the House to decide to adopt it or not to adopt it. But my issue is whether this could—Yes?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for catching your eye. Let me, on this matter, also indicate that, of course, the view being expressed, which I associate myself with, is to the effect that as Members of this House, we are concerned about the effect of the allotment of time as recommended by the Business Committee. So, in the event where a statement is made that it—Otherwise, it is only in the context that this position coming from the Business Committee should not be viewed as a means to minimise the oversight responsibility of this House when we invite Ministers or other constitutional bodies.

Mr Speaker, I am saying this to the effect that when we have a maximum time of six minutes allotted and spread as a minute for Question time, two minutes for the Minister to answer the Question, and then three minutes for both follow-up questions and then supplementary questions and answers, it becomes very unrealistic.

As a House, we should not just allot time for time's sake. We should be guided by the fact that there is no way a

Question that comes on this Floor can be managed within six minutes, particularly when, as Members of this House, we are entitled to also ask follow-up and supplementary questions. The fact that the supplementary questions ought to be admitted by the Speaker does not stop us from being given the opportunity to ask supplementary questions. In this House, particularly, when sensitive matters come up or matters of national interest come on this Floor—*[Interruption]*—Hon Senior, please, do not do that to your boy—We want all these things to be answered within six minutes. I think that is the challenge.

So, again, my respectful view to the Leadership of the Business Committee is that they should relook at the six-minutes allotment and be more realistic. If the issue is about the number of Questions that are asked within the one hour, they are the ones deciding, so, we can decide to limit the total number of Questions to five or six and have an effective deliberation on the Questions so that Ghanaians will benefit from it.

Mr Speaker, flowing from that, let me go to my other matters with regard to the Business Committee's Report, if I have your permission. Mr Speaker, we have had this consistent, repetitive indication concerning parliamentary representation to the ECOWAS Parliament and Pan-African Parliament. We were told of the urgency to get this issue resolved. Two weeks ago, Leadership spoke to us that they were almost at the conclusive end.

I still do not understand why we have these things unresolved as a House. What is it that Leadership is unable to reach compromises on? Why are we denying Ghana's representation in ECOWAS and Pan-African Parliament? Why are we allowing this to sit in our books as we close the Second Meeting of the First Session? Mr Speaker, it is completely untenable. So, Business Committee should resolve this once and for all. The Leadership of the House should resolve this issue of constituting representation for both Pan-African Parliament and ECOWAS Parliament, and that should be seen as a matter of urgency.

Mr Speaker, my last but one comment sits with this new and latest health concern of Mpox. Mr Speaker, as we speak, over 218 Ghanaians have been reported as infected with this Mpox. I believe that when the Business Committee sits, they should also be mindful of the exigencies and the topical issues that affect this country and Ghanaians. I am pleading with the Business Committee that the Minister for Health should be invited to this House. When he came earlier, he said everything was under control and fine and that they were stopping this infection. But as we speak, just yesterday, 21 Ghanaians have been reported infected with Mpox. So, I believe that the Business Committee should look at it.

Finally, Mr Speaker, the Minister for Energy and Green Transition was in this House yesterday to speak on the increase of electricity of up to 2.8 per cent. The Minister had indicated earlier in this House that because of the improvement

in the cedi, electricity prices were not going to go up. The same Minister has told this House that the imposition of the one GH¢1 per litre will not lead to increase in petrol. Go to the ex-pump price today, Ghana has more than 10 per cent increase in fuel prices. The Minister stood in this House and told us that a wise government, a government with acumen will introduce fuel and not get effect. Now, there is a 10 per cent increase in fuel prices in this country. What is this?

So, Mr Speaker, I think that the Minister for Energy and Green Transition—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I believe these are some of the reasons based on which the Business Statement is providing a guide.

12.08 p.m.

If the recommendation is that the Minister for Health be programmed to appear before the House and give a briefing on a stated thing because of a reason, you could have stated that in a simple language and in one minute. That is what the Business Committee is guiding us, so that we can make maximum use of our time. I believe if everybody can get up and go straight to the point, we will not spend the time we use to adopt the Business Statement. Because the Business Committee, under Order 71, has a right, based on the comment, to come with a supplementary Business Statement.

But are our comments resulting into a supplementary Statement? The time for

adoption of Business Statement has been reduced into a political platform; we want to make comments unrelated to the Business Statement. If you can make suggestion to the Business Committee, through the Chairman of the Business Committee, I believe the Chairman will organise a meeting that based on comments A, B, C, D, let us come out with a supplementary—

Yes, Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah?

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. I want to commend the Business Committee, through the Chairman, for a very detailed Statement; in particular, a number of Papers that will be laid on various days.

Mr Speaker, I want to recommend that they prepare a supplementary Business Statement, as you just mentioned, to include some other Papers. The reason is that there are Papers that concern issues of national interest, economic interest, programmes that have been launched by the government, which until date, we have not received a single A4 sheet detailing it, which will make the oversight function of Parliament difficult. I just want to bring to his attention: the Agriculture for Economic Transformation Agenda (AETA) or Feed Ghana was launched on the 14th April, 2025, and the programme document is not before Parliament; the One Million Coders Programme was also launched on 17th April, 2025, and the programme document is not before Parliament; the National Apprenticeship Programme, 30th April, 2025, and the programme

document is not before Parliament; the Adwumawura Programme, 28th April and the programme document is not before Parliament.

Mr Speaker, just about two weeks ago, the 24-Hour Economy, I think, was launched. The Speaker even admonished that it probably be laid before Parliament for our consideration. And on the 31st May, His Excellency the President announced a labour export programme with about 2,000 people to be sent abroad for work. Mr Speaker, it is important that the programme documents for all of these economic programmes are brought before this House, so that oversight can start.

So, I want to encourage the Business Committee to consider a supplementary and bring this policy or programme documents because we have just about two or three weeks to rise, so that this House can exercise its oversight function.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah, you have the floor.

Mr Emmanuel Kwasi Bedzrah: Mr Speaker, this House is ruled by the Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, Order 123(2)(b) of our Standing Orders says:

“(2) A Member shall not

(b) impute improper motives, or impugn the integrity of a Member or any other person.”

Mr Speaker, my Colleague mentioned that the Majority Leader is—Mr Speaker, that is imputing improper motives to the Majority Leader. The Majority Leader alone is not a Member of the Business Committee. The Member must be made to withdraw and apologise to the Majority Leader right now. We cannot be in the House of Representatives and make a statement anyhow; that Member must be made to withdraw the statement and apologise to the Majority Leader.

Mr Speaker, having said that, I want to commend the Business Committee for coming out with the next Business proposal for next week and we all know that this is a proposal and we need to approve of for this House to be carried along. My Colleague, Hon Boamah, mentioned that Motion that has been slated for the adoption of the Report of the composition of the Pan-African and ECOWAS Parliaments has been lying on the Order Paper for far too long.

Mr Speaker, in addition to that, an adoption of a report of the Special Committee on the full-scale investigation into the event which occurred at the public hearing at the Appointments Committee has also been lying on the Order Paper for far too long. We want to find out from the Majority Leader and the Business Committee when these three Motions will be taken.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity and I thank the Leader of the House.

Mr Speaker, there are few observations and I see that, on Tuesday, in the light of the proposed amendment to the time allotment for the prosecution of Business, I realised there is a proposal for 10 Questions per day. However, to the extent that this is a draft, we could consider an amendment to the draft because we are proposing 10 Questions per day.

However, we stand in breach. If you look at Tuesday, I counted the Questions proposed for Tuesday and there are 11 of them and, on Wednesday, there are 14 of them. So, if we are going by our own proposal, then we should make the necessary amendments, so that they stand at 10. I concede that Friday is, however, 10.

Mr Speaker, the attachment of the outstanding referrals is impressive and we pray that Chairpersons of the Committees will take this matter seriously. But it will not only be a burden on the head of either the Business Committee or the Chairman of the Business Committee. Mr Speaker, I think if we go into our Orders—May I invite you to Order 232(2)(h) which is on Ways and Means Committee and it says:

“... ensure that Committees submit reports as required by law”.

So, we do not need to put pressure on only the Majority Leader or the Business Committee. The Ways and Means Committee also have an input. They should have a function; it is chaired by the Deputy Majority Leader. He should advert his mind to it. I concede I am Member of the Committee and we would be happy to help.

But the Ways and Means Committee must also exert some leadership in this area. Because if you look at the outstanding referrals, it is something we cannot be boastful of as a House. So, let us help the Leader of the House and help the Business Committee. So, a complementary effort between the Ways and Means Committee would help in this regard.

The Business Committee is seeking to get clinical with time allotment to Businesses and how we can dispense of Businesses scheduled on the Order Paper. Mr Speaker, I also want to caution and counsel that we should also be clinical on the Businesses that are advertised on the Order Paper. Mr Speaker, with respect, we cannot keep advertising Businesses that are not ready to be prosecuted. For instance, the particular item on Ghana Cocoa Board (COCOBOD) has been on the Order Paper for months and the Motion the Hon spoke to, I am told there is an engagement by Leadership, yet we kept repeating that particular Business on the Order Paper. Why?

12.18 p.m.

How will the public take us? You put Businesses that are advertised for one month and you never take them; you always repeat them. So, we want to get clinical in time allotment? We want to get clinical in how we do Business on the Floor, so that we can close within reasonable time.

The Table should liaise with the Leader of Government Business and be in constant relationship, so that Businesses that are not ready to be taken are not repeated on the Order Paper. All in the spirit of getting clinical and neat in our Businesses.

Mr Speaker, I do not take it lightly; I respect the Majority Leader, but when he said the Governor of the Bank of Ghana cannot come—Now, the Majority Leader has signed this document, proposed Business Statement, and the Bank of Ghana has been featured. He said maybe, he should have made an amendment to the Report, but the Governor of the Bank of Ghana was scheduled to be here two weeks ago. He wrote a letter to Parliament and said that he is engaged in an equally important matter and hence, cannot come.

The same Question was rescheduled. Then the Governor, again, wrote another letter that we should reschedule. Fine. But, Mr Speaker, I am worried and I intend to ask, is it the case that when the Table Office goes through the motion of filing Questions and the Ministers cannot come, the Minister – either the Minister or an independent constitutional body –

can just sit in his office and write that he or she cannot come and decide not to come? This is because the writing of these letters from the Ministers to Parliament should be at the discretion of Parliament. Parliament must grant that request.

Mr Speaker, in other words, I am saying that when the Ministers write the letters seeking the rescheduling of these Questions that have been programmed, they should wait on Parliament to grant that request before they decide not to show up. They cannot just write the letter and decide not to come. Within two weeks, we have received 16 letters and this is the second time the Governor of the Bank of Ghana is writing. With respect to the Governor of the Bank of Ghana, when he writes to Parliament for one reason or the other, he should wait for Parliament to grant that request. So, I oppose that.

I oppose the Governor of the Bank of Ghana just saying that he cannot come. This is the representative of the people and he must respect us. Mr Speaker, I may sound very emotional, but it is not how we should prosecute Public Business and he is there as a public officer. He should respect this House. I hope the Majority Leader will relate to him. I do not want to call him or deal with him. When the letter of the Bank of Ghana comes, he should write officially and Parliament must consider whether we will grant that request or not. Very important. Well, he can decide not to show up. That is his business.

Mr Speaker, I raised this matter at the Business Committee on the matter of the cancellation of the erstwhile NPP Administration's policy on One District One Factory (1D1F). The response of the Majority Leader was that the decision actually came from the Minister for Finance or the Ministry of Finance; hence, we should rather direct our attention to the Minister for Finance.

Mr Speaker, I am aware we have passed the Exemptions Act and if it is the case that the policy of 1D1F is going to be cancelled and it is the decision of the Executive, then the Minister for Finance owes this House a duty. This is because within this transition period, there are a number of corporate entities who have signed on to the policy. What are the interim measures? Is it the case that we are disregarding the Exemptions Act that has been passed?

I initially thought that the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry should come and apprise us, but the Leader adverted my mind to where this concern actually originates from. So, to that score, I want to amend my call and say that our own Colleague, the exchequer, the Minister for Finance, I know how passionate he is about these matters of exemptions, must find his way here. We know he is coming here on 24th July, 2025, but this matter on exemptions must be spoken to in broader context.

Mr Speaker, let me conclude on the note of what we are reading on the internet: the scholarships for our students who are abroad schooling. We are told the University of Memphis has given a

deadline of 9th August as a date to sack Ghanaian students. It is not a palatable news. —[*Interruption*]—Well, I am raising it as a concern. If you beg to differ, you can speak. It is not a palatable news.

I think the Minister of State, Government Communications, Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu, should be preparing to come and tell us something. Giving us a deadline of 9th August for Ghanaian students to be sacked from the University of Memphis is a matter of public concern and I will be glad if an action is taken within reasonable time to deal with this concern.

I have spoken to the Deputy Leader about some statutory payment and I am happy to say that he has put in some effort. We have heard some good news, but it is not absolute. The Minister for Finance has confirmed that releases have been sent to National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) and Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund). Up till now, the administrators of these institutions have not done the needful.

Mr Speaker, from now till Thursday, when the Minister for Finance will come to this House, if we do not get confirmation of work done by the NHIA and GETFund, they must come. They must find their way here, at a Committee of the Whole, because Members are distressed and it is a matter of importance. I would not elucidate on this matter but I think the Leadership understands. I will be guided by your earlier counsel.

In conclusion, on composition of Committees, in line with Order 208, we stand in breach. Today at Conclave, I think we nudged the Majority Leader who has indicated—I have confidence in him, even though oftentimes, he tries to jab us. The Majority Leader has now taken delight in jabbing us and he does not want us to jab him. So, we nudged him on we standing in breach of Order 208 and Mr Speaker, your good self, you have been shortchanged by your Chief Whip. He has shortchanged the whole First Deputy Speaker. He should go and plead to the First Deputy Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I think this is a matter that we cannot just let it hang in. Let us deal with it. As the Leader of the House said, we would be rising soon and we cannot leave these matters hanging.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Yes, Hon Hajia Laadi, then I will call on the Chairman of the Committee to respond. Yes, Second Deputy Speaker, let me hear Hon Hajia Laadi, then I will give you the floor.

Hajia Laadi Ayii Ayamba: Mr Speaker, this is a House of record and we all know that whatever we discuss here on the Floor will be recorded and kept forever. It looks like we have brushed off an issue that came up when we had to discuss the time frame for Questions. A Colleague of ours on the other Side made a statement and I think it is appropriate for us to ensure that he withdraws that

statement and apologises. This is because he cannot in any way just impugn the fact that it is because the Majority Leader has a majority that he is using it to maybe, put whatever he wants on the Business Statement. It is not acceptable.

12.28 p.m.

He discussed the issue of time, and it is clearly stated on page 47 of the Standing Orders, Order 77(2) and with your permission, Mr Speaker, I read:

“Question time shall ordinarily not exceed one hour except that the Speaker may permit a Question after the expiration of the time stated.

So, ordinarily, this is what we have. We have it as our guidance, and we have to go by it. At the end of the day, if the Speaker realises that two minutes is not enough, or he wants to give more people the opportunity to ask Questions, the Speaker would be the one to do that. So, I do not see why a Member should come up when this is only a suggestion. We know that the Business Statement is only a suggestion. It is for us to discuss before we accept, and so, to say that the numbers the Majority Leader has is what he is using to do whatever he wants, is not fair. So, let us make sure that he withdraws and apologises, because it is not right; it is not acceptable. It goes down to tell the kind of business or talks that we have in this House. We should not brush it aside.

I thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Second Deputy Speaker?

Mr Andrew Asiamah Amoako: Mr Speaker, on Thursday, 24th July, 2025, the House will receive the Minister for Finance, and the Chairman of the Committee—Would the Majority Leader lend me his attention?

On Thursday, when we receive the Minister for Finance, will it be prudent for the House to also load the day with other activities; especially, Questions? For laying of Papers, I would not have any problem with that, but Questions? Does the Chairman think it will be prudent to have other activities; especially, Questions on that day? I want the Chairman to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Second Deputy Speaker.

Yes, Majority Leader, your response.

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, first and foremost, let me address the charge of dictatorship and oppression. Our Rules have been very clear from the beginning, except that we have been acting out of those Rules. In the past, because we sat from 10 a.m., which is early in the morning, it was easy to accommodate a lot of the deviations. But when we had challenges with Members attending Sittings at 10 a.m., and we decided to shift the Sittings to 2 p.m., that change also brought along with it some challenges. So, on the basis of those challenges, the Business Committee decided to see what we can do to ensure

that life is more bearable for Members of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, we are human beings. Yesterday, this Side of the House was accusing me of insensitivity. Why? Because a Member passed on, and I raised issues about the constitutional implications of a Statement made in this House. But even more importantly, have we asked ourselves, why the Member passed on? Have we gone to the hospital to find out the health records? The Member was in Takoradi the day before. He attended Committee meetings a few days before, and all of a sudden, in the middle of the night, the Member fell ill and could not be saved by the doctor. Do we know why our Colleague passed on?

So, we need to address the working conditions of Members of Parliament. When the Standing Orders say Members should work for five hours, and we keep stretching Members to work until the middle of the night, we keep stretching members to work until 10 p.m., 9 p.m., 11 p.m., under very strenuous circumstances, we are putting too much stress on the lives of Members of Parliament.

So, when the Rules give time allocations for Business, we need to insist on ensuring that we keep to those times, because those times have implications for the health of Members. So, the Standing Order is very clear. Order 77(2) says:

“Question time shall ordinarily not exceed one hour, except that the

Speaker may permit a Question after the expiration of the time stated.”

So, we decided that, let us discuss this; let us keep to time. How do we ensure that we keep to the one hour? We then took that one hour, multiplied it by the number of minutes we have in that one hour and multiplied it by the average 12 weeks that we have. Then, we now decided to divide that number of minutes by the number of Parliamentarians, and to give every Parliamentarian a certain average number of Questions to ask.

We zeroed in on the average time. Then we asked, how many minutes should suffice for asking Questions? We took the various Questions, and we ourselves at the Committee meeting attempted to read every Question averagely. We saw that averagely, for every Question, one will spend far less than a minute to ask the Question. Then we analysed the Answers. We saw that the Ministers themselves give us long, unnecessary Answers. So, a Member asks a simple Question, then the Minister gives a long Statement of background before he Answers the Question.

So, we concluded that we need to tackle the Answer from the side of the Minister and tackle the Question from the side of the Member of Parliament (MP), and then also provide guidance to the Speaker. We will talk to the Ministers to say that when they asked a Question, they should stick to the Answer of the Question. They should not give us a five-page Statement only for us to analyse, and it is only three paragraphs that really constitute the Answer to the

Question. What happens is that out of the five-page Answer, they open it up for MPs to now be asking follow-up questions on the backgrounds that they have given.

So, you realise MPs veer away from their Questions, to pick on all the things that they have said in the background statement to ask follow-up questions. This excites interest, then we will drag on, and instead of one hour, we end up spending three hours on Question time. So, we will tackle the problem from the angle of the Ministers, then we zeroed in on the six minutes on the average. So that everybody will have an opportunity in one minute to ask a given number of Questions. That was how we arrived at it.

Mr Speaker, if we want to see how it works in other jurisdictions, we should please monitor Question time in the United Kingdom (UK) and other advanced parliamentary democracies. We will see clearly that when they say one hour, it is exactly one hour. They will not go beyond the one hour unless under exceptional circumstances. That is where our Standing Orders picked up those practices and captured in our Rules; that it is one hour. We would not allow you to go beyond the one hour. It is clear.

12.38 p.m.

Unless the Speaker decides under exceptional situations and says that he will exceed that one hour due to certain exceptional circumstances". If I say that let us follow our Rules, I am not being a dictator. If in the past we have not been

following the Rules, it just means we have been doing the wrong things and if we are asking ourselves to start doing the right things, how does that convert somebody into a dictator?

Mr Speaker, the same principle applies to Statements. The Rules are very clear in Order 94 that the Statement time should ordinarily not exceed one hour. We asked ourselves the number of Statements we can take within an hour and we all agreed that it should be three Statements. There was a proposal that it should be four Statements. Then we said two should come from this Side and two should come from the other Side and I argued that if we do that, it will be unfair to this Side because we have 188 Members on this Side and we have 88 Members on that other Side. If we share Statements equally, then it means that many people on this Side will not have the opportunity to present Statements. So, in fairness if we agree on three Statements a day, we could allow two on this Side and one on the other Side so that everybody gets an opportunity to present one Statement. That is how come we concluded on the average of three Statements per day in this House. This was done, argued—Everybody was there. It was fair. So, I plead with Hon Members that the fact that we have been doing things that are wrong does not mean that we should continue doing them and I do not do these things out of a real—

The other day, when we were working on the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, 2025, I got a lot of text messages from parliamentarians that

they were exhausted so as the Leader I should save them. I had to run back. I came here and stopped it because I could see that people were tired; people were tired. So, if we start at 2 p.m., it is difficult to stretch people up to eight o'clock to nine o'clock but if we start at 10 o'clock per our body clock, by eight o'clock, we would still be awake. But we would have worked from 10.00 a.m. till 8 p.m.

So, I am pleading with you. I have no intention of being dictatorial or being oppressive. What will inure to the benefit of our health as Members of Parliament—Our survival; our longevity. If Hon Mohammed Amin Adam (Anta), the former Minister for Finance were here, he would tell us. One day he crossed to the other Side to tell me that,

“Leader, I think you should ask every Member to go to Korle Bu for a particular checkup and that because of the stress there is a particular ailment that we are susceptible to. So, please, can you tell every Member to go—Is there a way we can reduce the stress on Members of Parliament?”

I did not know until a doctor drew my attention to it and when I checked, I realised that it was real. Mohammed Amin Anta is here. If you ask him, he will tell you. So, we are doing everything possible to reduce the burden and reduce the stress on Members of Parliament so that we do not see the kind of incident that we are seeing in this House where we just lose Members and when we go and check, it is stress related.

Mr Speaker, now on what Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah asked, I will follow up. It is good that when the Ministers launch a policy to come and then present the policy to us. As Members of Parliament, for our information, it is good and then also for us to debate and sometimes make recommendations that will enrich the policy. So, I agree with him. I have actually passed it on and we will see how we get those policies laid in the House.

Subsisting reports should be taken—Yes, that is what we have been pushing for. Then, the Statement says that we should limit Questions to 10 but on some days, we schedule more than 10. So, if the Clerks-at-the-Table could amend and then shift the excess Questions to days that we have fewer than 10.

Mr Speaker, our attention was drawn to the responsibility of Ways and Means Committee to ensure that we have our reports presented by the various Committee Chairpersons. The 1 District 1 Factory (1D1F) briefings, I think we have debated this severally in this House and we actually debated and discussed it at the Business Committee meeting and I said this is a matter for the Minister for Finance and so I will discuss it with him and see how we can deal with that. Of course, I explained at the Business Committee meeting that the Policy that was introduced by President Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo was One District, One Factory. The proposal was that to facilitate and encourage the establishment of a factory in each district, we should give the proponents of

the business a tax waiver to enable them establish the factories.

This laudable proposal which would have covered just a little over 260 factories became subject to abuse where existing factories all clustered in Accra, Tema and Takoradi were demanding that they should also be given tax waivers for their businesses. We, as a Minority then, said we were not opposed to giving anybody tax exemption to facilitate their business but that is taxpayers money so if they were asking us to give it to them, we would insist that they comply with the law and we treat it as equity of government in their business or as a loan so that when they do the business and they are making profit, they can buy back the equity and then proceed to own their business. That has been our position on the matter but we are opposed to just giving blanket tax exemptions.

International Monetary Fund (IMF) Regulations, Rules, and Policies say that we are wasting money and yet we come to them asking for money. Government has money with a businessman, they will not take it, they have waived it for him then they come to IMF saying they should give them money; why would they give them money?

So, these are all issues that do not look well for the finances of the country. We are willing to give businesses whatever tax waiver they want, but let us treat it as a credit to the company. If you have a business, we are saying establish a factory. If the factory has US\$1 million and you have US\$800,000 and US\$200,000 amounts to tax of

government for you to import the equipment to establish the factory—We are saying that we can treat the US\$200,000 as credit to you so bring the factory equipment come and set it up and 20 per cent of the factory is government equity. If you do not want us to participate in your business, let us treat it as a credit when you establish the business and you are making profit, you will pay back. I mean it is a laudable proposal and it is in our legislation. So, I do not know why anyone will be opposed to this and insist that by hook or crook we must give factories exemptions and then what will Government run on? Because we run on the taxes; salaries are paid on the taxes.

Mr Speaker, I think we also will look at the problems of the students in Memphis. I think that some of these things actually are the Urgent Questions that should be asked in this House. These are real Urgent Question subjects that should be asked in this House but if the Minister is available to respond I am sure we will do that.

Then releases by the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) and the Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund), I think that these are matters that normally we discuss during Committee of the Whole meetings. We are following up; I believe that the Common Fund and NHIA—Indeed the Minister for Finance was in this House and he briefed this House and reported that since he assumed office, on a monthly basis, the NHIA releases have been going and the hospitals have been receiving and accessing their monies and so I am

surprised that a claim is being made in this House that NHIA releases are not coming. I can also confirm that I have spoken to the District Assemblies Common Fund Administrator and the releases are going to the various assemblies. I can confirm that because based on the issues raised in this House, I made calls and asked them and they confirmed that releases have been going to the various assemblies.

Mr Speaker, GETFund is also paying. I have received confirmation from some contractors that GETFund has paid them.

12.48 p.m.

The chairman of the Board is here and he can confirm that they have been paying contractors. Mr Speaker, I think those are the issues that have been raised.

Mr Speaker, Hon Colleagues should not forget that all these proposals the Business Committee has made are all subject to the discretion of a Speaker, based on certain circumstances. Even though all these proposals may be adopted by this House, the three Speakers maintain the discretion, as stipulated in our Rules, in certain circumstances, to allow Question Time to go beyond the one hour. They also maintain the discretion to allow follow-up questions to run for as long as Mr Speaker thinks is necessary, based on the exigencies of a particular Question and the Answers given to that Question. So, please, let us have confidence in the three Speakers to exercise their discretion

fairly and properly in our favour when the need arises.

Also, on the issue of the delegations to the various Parliaments, we are still talking to each other to be able to come to some consensus and if that is not possible, then we will have to find a way of adopting the Reports, but we will take them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in view of the regulation of time, I intend not to take more comments.

Hon Members, let me add my voice in indicating that the Business Statement, as presented today, is within our Rules. The Business Committee has not done anything outside the Rules and it is important for this to be made clear to Members.

The Business Statement is regulated by Standing Order 71(1) to (3), so we need to take that into consideration. Secondly, Question time is regulated by Standing Order 77(2) and it is one hour. Hon Members, our own Rules, in Order 94, regulate Statement Time and it is also one hour. Under Standing Order 216(2)(b), the Business Committee can recommend the allotment of time to this House. Therefore, if within our Rules, the Business Committee, made up of Members from both Sides, is recommending allotment of time, I do not think they are doing anything outside the Rules that govern the House. Accordingly, that cannot also amount to abuse of the majority.

I would, therefore, direct that the statement that the Business Committee recommending allotment of time within the Rules amount to—be expunged from the records.

On that note, the Business Statement, as presented, is accordingly adopted.

Yes, Majority Leader?

The next item is the item numbered 7, Urgent Questions.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I got a word from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice that he is unavailable this morning to answer the Questions and his Deputy is also in court. So, his Deputy is also unavailable to answer the Questions. So, I want to apologise on his behalf to those who have slated Questions this morning for answers from the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, so that we can reschedule the Questions.

Mr Speaker, in view of that development, we will not be able to take the item numbered 7. So, I plead that we vary the order of Business and if there are some admitted Statements—*[Interruption]*—Then also, we have an Order Paper *Addendum* which has some of the mining lease agreements that we have been calling on the Minister to bring to the House. Some of the agreements are here and I am sure that we are eagerly waiting for them to be laid. The Minister for Lands and Natural Resources is not here, but there is a Minister who, Mr Speaker, with your

indulgence, we can lay the agreements, so that they can be distributed to Members.

Mr Speaker, that is my current application.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Leader, you have the floor.

Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin: So, Mr Speaker, we just heard from the Majority Leader indicating that the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice has told him he is unable to be here. He also tells us that the Deputy Attorney-General and Minister for Justice is in court. So, Mr Speaker, the practise, as I know, is that if for some unavoidable reasons, a Minister of State is unable to come, he would write way ahead of time and indicate when he will be available to attend upon the House. Unfortunately, on this occasion, there is no such communication to the Table Office.

The Leader of Government Business is my Colleague. Upon receipt of the information, he could not reach out to me. He is only informing the House and he did not also indicate when the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice will make time to come to this House. Mr Speaker, I find this development unfortunate. These Questions have been pending for far too long. There has not been a communication from the Office of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice; any time we schedule the

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice, for some reason, he does not appear.

So, Mr Speaker, if a Minister of State who is a Member of Parliament will not make time for Parliament, then, I do not know how else we can function.

12.58 p.m.

Oftentimes, we are admonished that as Parliamentarians, we should use the tools available to us to engage in the public discourse. If we are using these tools and the Minister does not make himself available, then, Mr Speaker, what else can you do as an MP?

Mr Speaker, if you look at all the Questions, there are five Questions, which are all very critical Questions and they are matters that have been in the public space. The Minister has had the chance to talk about this on radio through press conference. Now, this is the House of Parliament; this is the place where the representatives of the people would have the opportunity to interrogate the matters. Yet, he is not making time for us. He is not even indicating his availability.

Mr Speaker, especially, if you look at the 7(c), the Question about the Economic and Organised Crime Office (EOCO) administrative decision to demand bail with justification, these are pure constitutional matters and it affects human rights. Mr Speaker, EOCO continues to arrest people and demand of them to provide landed property and titles before they are bailed. And people sometimes, because they do not get the

property, stay in for two weeks. The latest example is Mr Hannan, the former Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Buffer Stock. We had the former security chief, Kwabena Adu-Boahen, suffering the same fate. So, if the Attorney-General (A-G) is unavailable to deal with a thing like this, it becomes very problematic.

On the issue of the authorisation of the arrest of Prof Ameyaw-Akumfi, the A-G, on record, said he authorised the investigative body to arrest the person. Mr Speaker, nowhere in our Constitution is the Attorney-General given the power to order the arrest of a person. Nowhere. So, this is a matter that we can interrogate if he comes. But again, we continue to postpone. He is not here and he has not written.

Mr Speaker, for how long? People are concerned about the issue of *nolle prosequi*. Is there something of selective justice, where some people are being hauled to court and are being investigated, and for others, they are being told that we are not interested in prosecution?

Mr Speaker, I will plead with you by way of conclusion that the Leader of Government Business who received the information should, at least, get back to the A-G to give us an indication in the shortest possible time to come and answer these Questions. It has been pending for rather too long. I would even suggest that since we are sitting Monday—No, they have a programme on Monday—[Interruption]—All right. The Association of Northern Members of Parliament are having a programme in

Tamale on Monday and they have invited me, so I thought we will not sit on Monday. But since we will be sitting on Monday, let it be communicated.

Mr Speaker, you have the power to direct that it be communicated to the A-G to make himself available on Monday to answer these Questions. After that, we can go to Tamale to launch the Conference of Northern MPs. Leader, my plea is that you—*[Interruption]*—Pardon? No, but I am told we will sit before. Are we sitting on Monday, respectfully?

Very well.

Leader of Government Business, are you going to be the A-G? I have called you A-G three times. I do not want to be a prophet. But if you get there too, I will get my peace of mind here. If you go to the Attorney General's office and leave this black chair, I will have my peace of mind. Mr Speaker, that is on a lighter note.

Mr Speaker, the Leader of Government Business has indicated off record that Monday will be quite problematic, so, we can then look at Tuesday. And this should be communicated to him to make himself available.

I thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, the application before me is to vary the Order of Business, so

that we can take the item numbered 9 and that of the Order Paper *Addendum*.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, yes, the items on the main Order Paper numbered 9, and then—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: And the Order Paper *Addendum*.

Mr Ayariga: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, are we starting from the Order Paper *Addendum* or the main Order Paper—*[Interruption]*—Will we start with the main Order Paper? Which item, Leader?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon First Deputy Minority Whip, while I am speaking—Hon Members, fortified by Standing Order 67(2) which reads:

“The Order of Business set out in the Order Paper may, by leave of the Speaker, be varied at any sitting.”

I accordingly grant the leave and the order of Business is varied. I will consequentially direct that the Urgent Questions scheduled for the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice be rescheduled suitably as soon as possible.

So, Hon Members, at the Commencement of Public Business, the item numbered 9(b) to be laid by the Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection.

PAPERS

By Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection—

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 9(c).

Hon Members, before taking the item numbered 9(c), may I have your pleasure to acknowledge the presence of our student visitors in our midst.

Hon Members, we have pupils from Aristoland Montessori Centre, led by Gideon Yaw Agyei, a teacher. They are from the Krowor Constituency and are 68 in number.

[Pupils of Aristoland Montessori Centre were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have pupils from Ayensuako Catholic Basic School, led by Mr Agyepong Emmanuel, Ayensuako Parliament Leader. They are from the Awutu Senya West Constituency and they are 52 in number.

[Pupils of Ayensuako Catholic Basic School were acknowledged.]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have Himan Integration School Complex, led by Christian John Ampadu, Assistant Headmaster. They are from the Prestea-Huni Valley Constituency and are 65 in number.

[Students of Himan Integration School Complex were acknowledged]

1.08 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Attafuah Senior High School led by Mr Abu Wahab, National Commission for Civic Education (NCCE) Patron for Attafuah Senior High School. They are from Oda; they are 65 in number. Hon Members, on your behalf, I welcome them to the Parliament of Ghana. May you have a fruitful visit. Thank you for coming.

[Pupils from Attafuah Senior High School were acknowledged]

Yes, the item numbered 9(c).

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I crave your indulgence so that you will permit Hon Felix Ofori, Minister of State, Government Communications, to present the item on behalf of the Minister for Health.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we do not have any difficulty in that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

PAPERS

By the Minister of State, Government Communications (Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu) on behalf of the Minister for Health —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Centre for Plant Medicine Research for the Year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Health.

By the Minister of State, Government Communications (Mr Felix Kwakye Ofosu) on behalf of the Minister for Tourism, Creative Arts and Culture —

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Tourism Authority for the year 2024.
- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Theatre of Ghana for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze: Mr Speaker, the one of the Ghana Tourism Authority is for the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism, and the other one is for the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Hottordze, is National Theatre not under tourism?

Mr Hottordze: The tourism is divided into two. One part is for trade and the other part is for chieftaincy. So that one is for Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs and the one for Ghana Tourism Authority is for Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is the Ghana Tourism Authority not under the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs?

Mr Hottordze: No.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it under the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

Mr Hottordze: Yes, but the National Theatre, that is an agency under tourism and that part is for the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which one is for the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism?

Mr Hottordze: The Tourism Authority one is for the Committee of Trade, Industry and Tourism. What I want to explain here is that, we have Committee for Trade, Industry and Tourism. But, that Committee, some of the agencies under Tourism are under the Committee of Trade, Industry and Tourism. But some of the agencies under Tourism are also under the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs. All issues concerning creative arts and others are under the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious

Affairs. But the issues of tourism itself are under the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism. So, the Tourism Authority is under the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I need to be guided. Hon Member, as we cross-check, can we defer the item numbered 9(d)?

Yes, Majority Chief Whip? I will come to Hon Kyei.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, you know, you have led us in this matter that the nomenclatures of the departments are such that the functions that the Committee exercises vary depending on which agency. So, I have been a long-standing member of Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism. The agency under the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, are the Ghana Tourism Authority, the Tourism Development Fund, the Ghana Tourism Development Company, the Sedicom Limited—All these agencies that are under the Ministry of Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts, it is the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism that exercises oversight in respect of their activities. So, what the Chairman for the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism is saying is accurate, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kyei?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah: Mr Speaker, I was just rising to corroborate

the Statement that was made by the Chair for Tourism. As far as the National Theatre is concerned, it is being oversight by the Chieftaincy Culture and Religious Affairs Committee and so, that Report should be referred to the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the item on the National Theatre should be referred to the Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs.

Dr Asamoah: Exactly so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Guided accordingly,

- (i) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ghana Tourism Authority for the year 2024.

Referred to Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism.

- (ii) Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the National Theatre of Ghana for the year 2024.

Referred to Committee on Chieftaincy, Culture and Religious Affairs.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then, Hon Members, let us turn to the Order Paper *Addendum*: Presentation of Papers.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: The Minority Leader and Deputy Minority Chief Whip have agreed that Hon Felix Ofosu will present

the Papers on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr Speaker, particularly because the advocacy that has led to some of these mining lease agreements coming has been led by people on their Side. So, I will be surprised if they have any objection to the mining lease agreements being presented to this House because an objection will only delay the timing of the arrival in this House of the mining lease agreements. Week after week, they have been on me to make sure that the mining lease agreements get to this House. They are here, and they do not want them laid. Mr Speaker, it is obvious that they want it laid. So, they have no objection. They have agreed that Hon Ofose, Minister of State, Government Communications, will lay the Papers on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, I would still want to hear from them.

Yes, Minority Leader, there is an application on the Floor. The application is to the effect that the Minister of State, Government Communications, should lay the item for the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources.

[Pause]

Am I being ignored?

1.18 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, you can never be ignored.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, silence means consent. Hon Minister of State, Government Communications, you may proceed.

PAPERS

By the Minister of State, Government Communications (Mr Felix Kwakye Ofose) on behalf of the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources —

- (i) Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem West (16.59 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.
- (ii) Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Newmont Golden Ridge Limited for the mining of gold at Akyem East (47.67 km²) in Birim North District of the Eastern Region.
- (iii) Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Gateway Exploration Limited for the mining of gold at Obobetwao (33.37 km²) in the Birim North District of the Eastern Region.

- (iv) Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and GBF Associates Ghana Limited for the mining of Gold and other minerals at Ntotroso (49.77 km²) in the Asutifi North District of the Ahafo Region.
- (v) Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (Represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources) and Abosso Goldfields Limited for the mining of gold at Damang (52.39 km²) in the Wassa West District of the Western Region.

Referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, you have not admitted any Statement. *[Interruption]* There is a Statement?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, there are Statements.

Mr Mahama Ayariga: All right, then, we continue with Statements.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, before the Statement, I have a simple application, and I want the Leader of Government Business to take it up. I wish the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources were here to have dealt with it. Regarding the matters that were raised

by the President on 15th July, 2025, in Western North—

Mr Speaker, this is what the media is quoting the President to have said in his “Thank You Tour”. He said and I quote:

“We are alarmed by the environmental destruction that is reported across Awaso, Dadieso, and Sefwi Anhwiaso mainly due to illegal mining. I must be honest; this is a national emergency. The National Task Force will continue its effort to halt illegal mining in our forest reserves and on our water bodies.”

I wanted to plead with the Minister and the Leader of Government Business that in the light of this, if the Minister for Land and Natural Resources could come to Parliament and get Member of Parliament (MPs) to rally around this—

Mr Speaker, I am happy, that the President has acknowledged this, and he has put in place a task force. If the Minister can get MPs on board so that we understand the depth of the situation and all support it.

Mr Speaker, this is not a time to do partisan politics. This matter must be dealt with. Yesterday, the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources talked about the problems facing the Ghana Water Limited (GWL). I want to pledge my support on this matter so that all of us would get involved.

Mr Speaker, the situation is getting out of hand. I do not know the pleasure

of the Leader of Government Business, but this is what I really would want to say. So that as a House, we can all add our voice because the situation is really getting out of hand. That is all my prayer.

Mr Ayariga: I do not think there is any problem. The Minister has been to this House in the early days to give an indication the number of measures he is putting in place. The proposition is not the need to do something; it is how we couch it. When the Minority Leader says the situation is getting out of hand, I will oppose him because he knows that the situation was bad. We met a very bad situation, and we took very drastic measures. He himself has on several occasions spoken about the number of excavators that we have seized. We have told him about the directives that we have given regarding importation of excavators. There are excavators parked at the ports that cannot be cleared because we want to be able to track all excavators so that they do not get into the forest areas. If you block it at the port, it would not get to the forest areas. Those that are there, have been seized. So, they are not functioning. We have told him how we have reclaimed many of the forests.

So, those are matters that we have dealt with. It is a bad situation, and we are confronting it. So, it is how you present it. But I agree with him that the Minister should come and update us. It is a serious matter. So, we may do periodic updates. I remember immediately after his appointment as a Minister; he came on a number of occasions and read Statements here. We had a conference at

Kempinski, we the MPs, the Ministers and the Stakeholders, discussed the measures that they were going to implement with the Minerals Commission, Forestry Commission and the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture; they all came, and we discussed all these things.

So, I agree with him. We should have an arrangement where he comes periodically to update us. I will convey the message to the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, so that he avails himself and then gives us a briefing on where we stand in terms of the *Galamsey* fight and how to reclaim the environment. I agree with him. I will get the Minister informed. We will try and schedule him to come to the House.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, just to correct an earlier impression created by the Leader of Government Business in the early part of his submission.

Mr Speaker, the issue of *Galamsey* getting out of hand is not me saying it. I was actually quoting the President. I have the quote.

Mr Speaker, on Tuesday, 15th July, in the Western North Region, on a “Thank You Tour”, the President said this and I quote:

“We are alarmed by the environmental destruction that is reported across Awaso, Dadieso, and Sefwi Anhwiaso, mainly due to the illegal mining. I must be honest; this is a national

emergency. The National Task Force will continue its efforts to halt illegal mining in our forest reserves and our water bodies”

Mr Speaker, I am corroborating this position taken by the President with the position of Organised Labour on May Day.

1.28 p.m.

The Organised Labour also reiterated that the situation is getting out of hand. That is not me. I have not been to our forest reserves; I have not been there. But Organised Labour has a whole research infrastructure. For the Secretary General of TUC to come out publicly, on a May Day, in a Statement, to say that the *galamsey* situation is getting out of hand and for our President to acknowledge the alarming situation only calls for all of us to work at it.

Mr Speaker, I want to assure my respected Colleague, the Majority Leader, that I do not raise this issue with any partisan intent or that I want to score any political point—[*Interruption*]—No, with respect, Colleagues, if we want to trace the history of *galamsey*, as far back as 2015, Hon Seth Terkper—I was a Member of the Finance Committee. He came to meet us when cocoa production was going down and he lamented that because of *galamsey*, people were cutting down their cocoa trees and that was affecting cocoa production and it was affecting the economy. So, I do not want any of us to think that a party will get advantage by saying this or that. The thing is a national emergency.

If the Minister would be candid, he would tell us how he feels frustrated about this *galamsey*. Mr Speaker, so I am not being partisan on this matter, neither am I the one saying it is getting out of hand. So my Colleagues should not have a problem at all. It is what is coming from the data.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, your points are noted.

We have a Statement standing in the name of Hon Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah, Member of Parliament for Salaga South Constituency, on child abuse in the new Ankansah community.

Hon Members, if the Hon Member is not available, we will then take a Statement on teenage pregnancy.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

STATEMENTS

Recent Cases of Child Abuse in Ghana

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah (NDC — Salaga South): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to make this Statement in relation to child abuse cases in Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I begin my Statement by expressing my profound gratitude to the organisers of the recent Inter-Parliamentary Union (IPU) on Human Rights for convening a very vital workshop in Accra, Ghana. It was an honour to join fellow parliamentarians and human rights advocates in our shared

vision to advance justice, dignity and protection for all, particularly for the most vulnerable.

Mr Speaker, today, I rise to address an urgent matter of national and global concern. The persistent scourge of child abuse and the critical need to safeguard the rights of vulnerable populations. Mr Speaker, despite Ghana's robust legislative framework, including the Children's Act 1998, (Act 560) and the Domestic Violence Act 2007, (Act 732), child abuse remains a pervasive challenge.

Mr Speaker, the 2023 Ghana Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey reveals that, approximately, 22 per cent of children aged 1 to 14 experience violent discipline with reports of physical, emotional and sexual abuse occurring with alarming frequency. These violations, Mr Speaker, not only contravene the United Nation (UN) Convention on the Rights of the Child to which Ghana is a signatory, but also jeopardise the physical, psychological and social development of our children.

Mr Speaker, vulnerable groups, children, persons with disabilities and marginalised communities face heightened risk due to systemic inequalities, social stigma and inadequate protection mechanisms. Poverty, limited access to education and weak enforcement of child protection laws further exacerbate these challenges.

Mr Speaker, as lawmakers and custodians of human rights, we must intensify our efforts to address these issues through the following measures:

One, we have to strengthen legal frameworks and enforcement, bolster the capacity of law enforcement and judicial systems to investigate, prosecute and adjudicate cases of child abuse effectively, ensuring adequate resources and specialised training.

Two, we have to promote awareness and education and launch nationwide campaigns to educate communities on the rights of children and vulnerable groups, fostering a culture of zero tolerance for abuse and encouraging the reporting of violations.

Three, there is the need to support victims and survivors and expand psychosocial support, rehabilitation programmes and safe shelters to aid victims in their recovery and reintegration into society.

Four, we must foster multi-sectorial collaboration to encourage partnerships among governments, civil society, traditional authorities and international organisations to build a comprehensive and sustainable child protection ecosystem.

Mr Speaker, on 25th June 2025, while the Inter-Parliamentary Union on Human Rights workshop was ongoing, a deeply disturbing video surfaced on social media, depicting a 12-year-old child in a Ghanaian community bound by nylon ropes to a roof and brutally beaten by three adults. This shocking footage was first brought to my attention as I travelled to attend the Inter-Parliamentary Union on Human Rights workshop and it compelled me to act swiftly. I mobilised my network to identify the location of

this heinous crime and I was heartened by the rapid response that followed.

Mr Speaker, I want to use this opportunity to commend the Ghana Police Service (GPS) for its swift and professional response in rescuing the 12-year-old victim depicted in the viral video. As confirmed by the Regional Police Headquarters in Sekondi, the two suspects were arrested. The child received immediate medical attention before being reunited with his father. This decisive action underscores the importance of a zero-tolerance approach to child abuse and serves as a model for effective intervention.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, protecting children and vulnerable groups is not only a legal obligation but a moral imperative that reflects the values and commitment of our society to human dignity. As parliamentarians, we have the power to enact transformative policies that ensure every child and vulnerable individual thrives in an environment free from abuse and discrimination.

Mr Speaker, let us reaffirm our collective resolve to champion human rights, protect the vulnerable and build a future where every child in Ghana and beyond can live in safety and dignity.

I thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Statement is duly presented. The floor is now open for comments.

Hon Leaders, today being Friday, how many do we take from each Side?

Then, I will give the floor to Hon Twumasi Ampofo.

Mr Kwame Twumasi Ampofo (NDC — Sene West): I thank you, Mr Speaker and I also commend the maker of this Statement, Hon Zuwera.

1.38 p.m.

Mr Speaker, a lot of children go through a lot, such as physical, mental and emotional abuse. Some parents themselves abuse their children. Therefore, it is important for us to look at it critically, especially children who cannot talk. Also, the caretakers or babysitters sometimes abuse some of these children by giving them drugs to sleep, so that they can be quiet and they do whatever they want. This affects the children in the long run. If one goes to most advanced countries where they have hidden cameras, that is where most of these comes out. Some of them will put the children under their armpits and beat them, so that the parents will not see anything, but they will be abusing or harming the children physically.

Mr Speaker, child abuse comes in so many forms that these children go through. Therefore, it is about time for us to protect these children. Some also abuse them by beating, insulting, undermining and underestimating them. Sometimes, the way some parents or adults look at some children affects them emotionally and physically. Therefore, it

is important for us to critically look at this issue of child abuse.

Mr Speaker, I do not have much to say, but I thank you for giving me the opportunity to add my voice.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon John Darko?

Mr John Darko (NPP — Suame): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for this opportunity. I thank the maker of the Statement, Hajia Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah, for this all-important Statement on child abuse. She has done a very good job.

Mr Speaker, in her Statement, she asked the House and Members here to strengthen the legal framework and enforcement of our laws, and I cannot agree more with her. In this country, we have a lot of laws to protect the children. We have The Children's Act, 1998 (Act 560), Criminal and Other Offences Act, 1960 (Act 29), and a lot of provisions that protect—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon John Darko, hold it.

Hon Members, the Hon Second Deputy Speaker to take the Chair.

Please, continue.

1.42 p.m. — [MR SECOND DEPUTY SPEAKER IN THE CHAIR]

Mr Darko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

So, we have a lot of laws that protect the children of this country. What we have always lacked is the enforcement of our laws. Mr Speaker, as the Hon Member has made this Statement, it is my hope and belief that our law enforcement agencies will be up to the task to punish the offenders of these heinous crimes.

We understand the purpose of punishment. One of them is to deter people from continuous violations of our laws. So, Mr Speaker, while thanking the Hon Member for the Statement ably made before this House, I hope that our law enforcement agencies will also listen to us, punish offenders, and make sure those who even think of engaging in some of these heinous crimes will know the punishment and run away from it.

Mr Speaker, on that note, I thank you for the opportunity and I yield the floor.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member for Pusiga?

Hajia Laadi Ayii Ayamba (NDC — Pusiga): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the Statement ably made by my Colleague, Hon Zuwera.

Mr Speaker, the issue of child abuse has been discussed on this Floor several times, but, unfortunately, it continues to happen. The issue that Hajia Zuwera has brought to bear now is an issue that I actually posted the video on our platform. It was very pathetic.

Mr Speaker, according to later findings, the boy is about 12 years old. It is quite pathetic because there was no room at all given to that boy for escape. His two hands were tied, he was completely naked and hanged. Mr Speaker, if you saw the way the macho man raised the stick to beat the boy, the first thing that occurred to me was that, no, that was not their child. It was quite horrible. People stood around, Mr Speaker; that was the painful aspect. Although we could see some of the women clutching their hands and looking very sad, some had the impudence to video; yet, nobody could save the child.

Mr Speaker, there was an elderly man; my pain is just on him because at his age, he should not allow such a child, who can be his grandchild, to be given that type of treatment. I was even wondering whether the child would survive because to have hanged him—It came to a time that he could not weep or do anything, he was just there and they were beating him. Mr Speaker, it will shock you to know that at the end of it, the old man—And later on, read and found out that he was carrying a small container like a cup of pepper which he rubbed into the wounds, even on the front and the base of the child. I was so devastated and I just wondered.

Mr Speaker, some of these cases are of children who have been adopted. The local type of adoption, not the good one or the documented ones. Some parents give their children out to relatives to take them, for whatever reason, I do not know, and this is how it ends.

Mr Speaker, this incident needs to be followed. I spoke with the MP for the area and he told me that, actually, they have been arrested and are on remand. I believe that imprisonment would help. They should be imprisoned for not less than five years each. My humble suggestion.

Mr Speaker, with all humility, we should all be very conscious of our surroundings. We should also make sure that we look around and continue to give education. Mr Speaker, the abuse is not only of children who might have been given out to their relatives to support them. Even in our schools, we tend to see some of these incidents. A child comes home and his body marks tell us that he has been whipped. For whatever reason, I do not know. The law says no corporal punishment, and that corporal punishment can only be given by the headmaster or at his instruction and it should be a number of strokes just to correct the child. Yet, we have it that a teacher, for whatever reason, would whip a child until the child has marks on his or her body. Mr Speaker, it is quite unfortunate.

The laws are there. Let us support the law enforcing agencies by giving them the right information, standing for the children, and making sure that those who caused the harm are prosecuted. If they do not have the information, they are not able to act. If we are not ready to stand for them to prosecute, they will not be able to do it.

Mr Speaker, the other thing is that parents must be ready to support law

prosecuting agencies. Because some parents will sometimes come out to say that that is the uncle, auntie or mother of the child. If the child had died, he would not be an uncle or auntie to anybody.

1.48 p.m.

So, we must ensure that we also educate parents that when such a thing happens to their child, if they will not be able to talk when they are called upon, they should stay away and let the law deal with those people.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I thank you very much for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement and let me say well done, Hon Zuwera, for the Statement. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Simon Akibange Aworingo (NDC — Navorongo Central): Thank you very much for the opportunity, Mr Speaker. Child abuse, in every form, should be condemned because not only is it not good for the overall development of the child, but also it affects their future. Child abuse affects not only the physical development of the child, but also the psychological and emotional development of the child. And so, I think that whatever form of abuse that a child is put through, as leaders of the country, and as future leaders that we are bringing up, we should condemn it.

In our part of the world, we tend to believe that as the Bible says, you spare the rod and spoil the child. And we consider it to be physically abusing the child as a way of training the child or giving discipline. I feel that we must

come to a point where we show love to the children, that discipline must be a way that is not affecting them physically or psychologically. I want to add my words to say that we should find ways of disciplining children without physically abusing them so that they can develop into the leaders that we want. Studies have shown that a child that is abused physically grows up to become violent. And we want to raise leaders who will become very friendly, responsible, and all of that. And in order to achieve that, we must show love to these children rather than physically abusing them.

I urge that we all support the Statement and ensure that children are trained and disciplined in a way that does not affect their psychological and emotional growth.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. I am told the directive is one each.

Hon Member for Manso-Nkwanta?

Mr Fokuo: Mr Speaker, we agreed to do one on each Side; we have exhausted ours. I believe we can move on.

Yes, that is in order.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: We will take the second Statement, and that is coming from the Hon Member for Suame. Hon Members, the arrangement that we all understood this morning is that for Statements, we take two from the

Majority and one from the Minority; that is what we agreed on. So we have taken one here, we are taking one here, then we come back here. I hope we are all on the same page.

Yes, Hon John Darko?

Green Transition and its Effect on the Auto Industry in Suame

Mr John Darko (NPP — Suame):

Thank you very much, Hon Speaker, for the opportunity to make this Statement on the green transition and its effects on auto mechanics in my Constituency, the Suame Constituency, and to a greater extent, the over a million mechanics across the country.

Mr Speaker, His Excellency, the President, by Civil Service (Ministries) Instrument, 2025 (E. I. 1), created the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition. The creation of the said Ministry, in my view, signifies the intent and direction of the President in respect of the nation's commitment to the 2015 Paris Agreement. It also shows the country's desire to gradually move from fossil fuel as a major source of energy to green sources of energy.

Mr Speaker, green energy is the energy source which has zero or minimum environmental impact, as more environmentally benign and more sustainable, and produced from solar, hydro, biomass, wind, geothermal, *et cetera*. It is believed that transitioning from the current fossil fuel, which is the coal, petroleum, and natural gas to green energy will help in the reduction of

emissions and thereby saving the world from reaching the dreaded two degrees Celsius.

Mr Speaker, the green transition has led global shifts towards the use of electric vehicles as compared to combustion energy vehicles. Mr Speaker, this has significant implications for the country and my Constituency in particular. My Constituency is an industrialised area with many workshops for metal, artisanal engineering, and vehicle repairs, and provides direct and indirect jobs to about 500,000 Ghanaians. Mr Speaker, across the country there are over 500,000 more workers who are also auto mechanics and depend on fixing combustion energy vehicles to make ends meet.

Mr Speaker, the embracing by the world, especially Europe and Asia, of the green transition has led to proliferation of electric vehicles (EVs) into the world and in Ghana. According to the International Energy Agency (IEA), as of 2023, there were over 40 million EVs in the world, compared to 26 million in 2022 and zero in 2013.

Mr Speaker, the former Minister for Energy, Dr Matthew Opoku-Prempeh, told the country in 2023 that there were about 17,000 EVs in the country. We also witnessed the former Vice President, His Excellency Dr Alhaji Mahamudu Bawumia, in 2024, leading the importation of some electric vehicles into the country for public transportation services. Indeed, the former Administration had plans to introduce 1,000 electric buses and related charging and

maintenance infrastructure for intra-city (40 per cent) and intercity (60 per cent) transport services.

Mr Speaker, I know the introduction of EVs into the country sounds good for the country's nationally determined contributions to reducing emissions, but therein lies the difficulty my Constituency faces. The introduction of EVs are going to cause serious job losses in my Constituency.

Mr Speaker, there is nothing more important in nation building than job creation. Indeed, it is when the people have jobs that they can pay taxes to the government to build the needed infrastructure. It is when the people have jobs that they can take care of their families and their loved ones. The focus of every government, Mr Speaker, including this Government, I believe, is to create jobs. I am therefore afraid that our fixation on green transition, in my view, will take away jobs from over a million Ghanaians whose jobs depend on fixing combustion energy across the country.

Mr Speaker, why do I say this? With the introduction of electric vehicles, combustion energy will be a thing of the past. With the phasing out of combustion energy, the workers who work on engine block, cylinder head, intake and exhaust valves, crankshafts, fuel system, lubrication system, gaskets and pistons, pumps, timing belts, water pumps, and those who sell oil filters and engine oil across the length and breadth of this country are going to lose their jobs.

Mr Speaker, I know the counter argument will be that as the world embraces renewable energy sources, as solar and wind power and move to EV usage, there will be an increased demand for mechanics who are skilled in maintaining and repairing these advanced systems and that this shift will open up new avenues for business growth and specialisation in EV maintenance and repair services.

My question to this is, how many jobs will be created from this? Can the jobs that come with EVs replace the loss of millions? Even that, it requires an extensive training and upskilling of traditional auto mechanics to equip them with the knowledge and expertise required for the new technologies.

1.58 p.m.

What happens to our illiterate brothers and sisters, if I may put it that way, who have specialised in the combustion energy services enumerated above? Are we going to train our 50, 60 and 70-year-olds who have gained decades of experience in those fields?

Mr Speaker, I am afraid that as a country, we are so quick to accepting concepts like green transition, energy transition, climate change and the likes but we do really nothing on our own to escape their harsh realities. Do we have the hand tools and diagnostic instruments to accommodate the specific needs of the renewable energy systems and electric vehicles? How have we invested in the modern workshops, equipped with latest technology, which

will obviously be essential to stay competitive in the evolving markets?

Mr Speaker, I know, unfortunately, my fear will come true. What was considered futuristic is now upon us. However, with the appropriate support and training programmes, these individuals can be integrated into the green economy, ensuring a just and an inclusive transition for all. This is what I expect the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition to do. Our Government, the Government of Ghana, must be deliberate and purposeful in this approach to replace the job losses that will come with the influx of EVs.

Mr Speaker, in conclusion, I hope that like-minded Colleagues will join me to lead a Private Member's Bill, which will mandate the Executive to set aside funds to take practical steps to prepare our auto mechanics across the length and breadth of this country, and particularly my Constituency, with the needed skills and technology to face the eventual future.

I thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member for Suame.

Hon Members, the Statement has just been read to us. We will take one from each Side.

Yes, Hon Member for Offinso North?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (NPP — Offinso North): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I would like to commend the

maker of the Statement, Hon Member for Suame, on green transition and its effects.

Mr Speaker, green transition and advancement in technology is definitely going to disrupt jobs, but not only disrupting jobs, it is also going to create more jobs.

In fact, the International Labour Organisation (ILO) estimates that green transition and green jobs is estimated to be about 24 million by the year 2030, and in Africa alone, about 3.3 million jobs are going to be created as a result of green transition. In fact, the United States now has about 6 per cent of its jobs as a result of green jobs and is expected to be moving to about 14 per cent. That means Ghana will not be different.

Mr Speaker, nobody will want to fight against green transition. Why? Because the auto mechanics are not only in Suame. When you come to Offinso North, in fact, we have auto mechanics in Afrancho, Akomadan and Nkenkaasu. But the sad truth is that our auto mechanics are exposed to toxic metals by the way of our work. You know, we moved from manual transmission cars to auto transmission cars, and now electric vehicles are here. I remember gone are the days when we used to take our carburetors out and used fuel to clean it ourselves. I could do it myself, but now I cannot do it anymore. So, we have to prepare our generation and the current workers to be able to appreciate the transition we are going through.

That means that we should not just put in policies, but Government should

start investing heavily in electricity infrastructure and green energy. With this, we can develop more electric stations because electric vehicles have come to stay, and in no time, the same way people are hesitant in moving from manual transmissions to auto transmission; the same thing is happening. But by the time we realise, by 2030, we cannot count the number of automatic transmission vehicles in Ghana, but it will be more of electric vehicles.

That is why the previous Government started by developing curriculum for how we can maintain electric vehicles and this curriculum has already been developed. All that we need to do is not just put it on the shelves, but collaborate with all training institutions and public-private partnerships, to make sure that this curriculum are used to train and retrain our auto mechanics; it does not matter where they are. If we are able to do that, we can also promote local manufacturing. If we are worried about job creation, we need to start promoting local manufacturing because all the time, we are importing our vehicles. When it was manual, we were importing; when it is automatic, we are importing. Are we also going to continue to import electric vehicles in Ghana or in Africa?

For these electric vehicles, please, this is the time that the Government has to put in all the policies, strategies and the investment that will allow us as a country to also produce electric vehicles in this country. We have the mechanics; they have the skills. When you go to Abosse Okai, they have the skills. Like I said, if you come to Offinso North,

Akomadan auto mechanics have the skills.

This is the time and the time is now that we have to make investments in electricity and infrastructure that will support the development of electric vehicles and its usage so that we can create the jobs here back home. It is the time for us to do that.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, my Brother. I forgot your Constituency. Kindly remind me?

Mr Kpotosu: Ho Central, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Ho Central, yes. You took over from the almighty Kpodo.

Yes, let us hear you.

Mr Richmond Edem Kofi Kpotosu (NDC — Ho Central): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for indulging me. If I understood my Brother on his Statement, his fear is that the mechanics at Suame will lose their jobs, and it calls for skills upgrade, but I want to make him aware that the engineers he sees in Suame are way ahead of even the EV cars, and I know that majority of them are upgrading their skills at a faster rate. So, please, when he goes to the Constituency, he should try as much as possible to visit them and get the updates from them. They will even educate him that when the cars come, this is how they are going to handle them.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much for indulging me.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you a mechanical engineer?

Mr Kpotosu: I have a lot of friends there.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: At Suame Magazine?

Mr Kpotosu: Yes.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: All right.

Mr Kpotosu: Mr Speaker, they are working hard. Day in, day out, they are on the internet, doing researches; so they are not going to be put out of jobs. They are finding ways and means of surviving.

Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you, my Brother, Member for Ho Central. I am taking one each in addition.

Yes, Dr Anabah, let me hear you.

2.08 p.m.

Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (NDC — Garu): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. I am very happy to hear my Brother over here crying for the good people of Suame. I would cry for transformation of our educational system to meet current demands, because those in Suame today, by five or six years' time, they may not be able to meet the exigencies of

technology in this world unless they themselves transform themselves. So, there will be a need for Ghana as a whole to look at our educational system to see whether the products of our education are meeting current demands for development.

Countries like Zimbabwe and Rwanda are manufacturing electric cars. Somebody has even manufactured a car that uses electric frequencies to move and EVs have come to help the environment because combustion that is incomplete, I think the environmentalists will tell you, would cause a lot of damage to us, as human beings.

If Ghana wants to stay up at the same level with other countries, we have to transform our educational system to ensure that we can also manufacture parts because the EVs are not done in one country. The parts come from several countries.

Why can we not tweak our educational system to ensure that we teach what the former MP has done — I would say it — the STEM system, where the children learn about robotics and the rest early enough in their life, so that when they grow, they have the love for engineering and technology, not only book and, at the end, they cannot even service a bicycle when it is broken. So, we need to tweak our educational system. It will even give more employment.

For a small EV, if you count the components in it, they are several. Why can Ghana not also train thousands of people to manufacture some components

of the EV or the solar system? It will create jobs. So, to think that introducing electric vehicles in this country would take away jobs, to me, it cannot be factual. It cannot be proven anywhere. We rather need to upgrade our educational system to meet modern demands of technology and development. That is what I would say.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me go to Akuapim North.

Mr Samuel Awuku (NPP — Akuapim North): Mr Speaker, I thank you and, also, let me thank the maker of the Statement.

Mr Speaker, I think the issues here also go to the very core of what many of our constituents also expect. The advent of industrial revolution in Europe came with its own attendant job losses. But the government of the day made a deliberate effort at that time to make sure that its citizens were properly cushioned. If I also listen attentively to the maker of the Statement, one of the cardinal recommendations that he also made was for the upgrade of skill and training for many of our people in the area of auto mechanics, its repair and maintenance.

What I find also comforting is that our people are always yearning to upgrade and also learn. I believe we need to embrace this whole green transition because that is where the world is heading towards. But I am also standing 100 per cent shoulder to shoulder with him because, in his constituency, his competitive advantage is in the area of repairs, maintenance and auto mechanics.

And any disadvantage caused to the people there also has its own ripple effect. What I would also advise and challenge Government to do is to—Now, we have the advent of the EVs and we cannot stop this advent and revolution and they gradually are even taking over greater space in terms of our automobile industry.

But what we can do and do effectively is to make sure that Government, through its own channels—If we take an institution like the Youth Employment Agency (YEA), it has many young people, especially in the various models, that are created to train people into jobs and several artisanal training centres that they normally establish.

I believe that the time then is now for us to also model some of the things we do to fit into plan of the Government towards the future because it is just like the issue of digitalisation. At first, nobody ever thought that a time will come when one would not have to be called to the Ghana Post to wait for a phone call from a loved one abroad. Now, through the mobile technology, a person can interact with friends and loved ones across the world. That is how the EVs are also approaching this generation.

So, I will commend the maker of the Statement but challenge Government that we should not wait for it to take root across the country and then we will be thinking about how to upgrade our people and give them decent conditions as well. Mr Speaker, I commend the

Member for Suame for knowing that this will not just affect Suame but will affect EV mechanics in Fomena and in the Akuampim North and across the country.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much for mentioning Fomena.

Hon Members, we will take the last Statement from Hon Rachel Amma Owusuaa, Member of Parliament for Dormaa East Constituency and the Statement is on Teenage Pregnancy.

Ms Owusuaah: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon, hold on. Give me some more time.

Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I want to pray for your benevolent indulgence for me to contribute or for— It is a very important subject matter.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Let me hear you.

Hon Member, give me some time; after his contribution, I will come to you.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, can I speak or he speaks and I conclude?

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: No, I would not give the two to you.

I will just give you one and if possible—Already, the protocol we have established was that we should give—

Mr Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I think the initial idea was that if we are taking about two or three Statements, we will do all the Statements and Leadership will conclude and choose whichever ones they want to comment on. That was my understanding.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member for Dormaa East, let me hear you.

Teenage Pregnancy

Ms Rachel Amma Owusuaah (NDC — Dormaa East): I thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I rise to talk about a serious issue that affects young girls and our society: teenage pregnancy. As a midwife and a Member of this House, I have seen how teenage pregnancy harms the health, education and future of young girls. This issue needs our urgent attention, especially since my constituency, Dormaa East, ranks second in Bono region for teenage pregnancy, abortion, and HIV infections.

Mr Speaker, over the past three years, teenage pregnancy in Dormaa East has been rising. In 2022, there were 292 reported cases. The number dropped to 218 in 2023 but increased to 227 in 2024. These numbers show that we must take action to reduce teenage pregnancy and support our young girls.

Mr Speaker, there are several reasons for this problem. Poverty is a key factor, as families with little money may push young girls into relationships for financial help. Family problems, including the lack of parental guidance and unstable homes, can leave teenagers vulnerable. Many young people do not receive enough information about reproductive health, leading to risky choices. Peer pressure from friends can also lead to early sexual activity and some cultural practices, such as early marriage, add to the problem.

Mr Speaker, teenage pregnancy has serious effects. Young mothers face health risks, including problems during pregnancy and childbirth. Some may turn to unsafe abortions, which can lead to serious health problems and even death. Many teenage mothers drop out of school, which limits their future opportunities. Without education and essential skills, they often face financial struggles, which can lead to poverty and risky behaviour, including substances abuse and unprotected sex. Society often judges teenage mothers, which can lead to shame and isolation.

Mr Speaker, solving this issue requires teamwork from the Government, non-governmental organisations (NGOs), development partners and families, schools and the traditional authorities, which need to improve access to family planning services, including contraceptives like condoms and birth control for those who are sexually active and may not be able to abstain. Schools should teach young people about reproductive health, safe sex and the benefits of abstinence.

Traditional leaders, especially queen mothers, should promote cultural practices that encourage responsible behaviour.

2.18 p.m.

Mr Speaker, providing girls with sanitary pads can help prevent situations where they seek financial help from boys during their menstrual periods when their parents or guardians are unable to provide. Keeping girls in school and offering skills training will help them build better futures. Creating a girls' club focused on reproductive health will give young girls a safe space to learn, share and receive guidance.

Mr Speaker, it will not be out of place for the Government and development partners to offer skills training programmes to these young girls who find themselves in this hapless situation; otherwise, the cycle will continue. Mr Speaker, teenage pregnancy harms both young girls and society as a whole. Families, schools, health workers and the Government must work together to solve this problem. By giving our young girls knowledge, support and opportunities, we can help them make better choices and create brighter futures.

I thank you, Mr Speaker. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. The applause is high, so let me give the opportunity to the Hon Ladies first. Yes, let me come to you first, then I will go there. Rev Ntoso, I will come to you.

Mrs Ernestina Ofori Dangbey (NDC — Agona West): Mr Speaker, I would also like to use this opportunity to commend my Hon Sister and Colleague, Hon Rachel Owusuah, for the Statement.

Mr Speaker, teenage pregnancy has become a significant issue in our various communities across the country. An urgent solution is needed to control the situation. The most painful aspect of it is that when the guy involved in this act is a student, he tends to go back to school while the teenage girl stays at home for about two or three years before re-entry and at times, some of them do not go back to school at all. If they do not get any support from anywhere, these teenage girls become a liability to society.

Mr Speaker, last year during my campaign, I visited a certain community and met a teenager who was pregnant. Looking at her age, I became so interested in her, so I drew closer to her just to have a discussion. Surprisingly, I realised she became pregnant because she could not afford to buy sanitary pads. Per her story, she was advised by friends to go in for a boyfriend and that when she takes a boyfriend, the guy will provide everything for her. So, she took the advice from her friends and that was the result: being pregnant and dropping out of school.

Mr Speaker, I was so glad when I heard one of the policies of His Excellency John Dramani Mahama, One Girl, One Sanitary Pad because I believe this will go a long way to help our youth and curb the teenage pregnancy situation in our country.

Mr Speaker, I would like to use this opportunity to also advise the big men out there to allow our little girls to grow. They should allow them to continue with their education, so that they will become responsible people in future to help mother Ghana. Then to the girls, I will plead with them to concentrate on their books. The truth of the matter is that when they grow and become someone better in future and they get married, they can decide to do this thing twice in the morning, afternoon and evening. No one will question them. So, please, that is the advice I am giving to our little girls out there. Abstinence is the best key.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

I will go to Akuapem South?

Ms Lawrencia Dziwornu (NDC — Akuapem South): Mr Speaker, I rise to comment on the Statement ably delivered by my Colleague, Hon Racheal Owusuah.

Mr Speaker, while her concerns are really valid, the situation is not isolated. In Akuapem South alone, this situation is quite troubling. In 2023, we had over 100 cases in six months. In 2022, the situation doubled. This is a matter of urgent national attention and I think we all need to pay attention to this issue of teenage pregnancy.

Mr Speaker, one major contributing factor I have come to realise is that parents nowadays do not protect their

children or their girls as we used to in the past. Now we find young girls gallivanting on the streets at night and men take advantage of these young beautiful ones. Mr Speaker, I find it very sad when I see young girls being robbed of their future and the men or the boys responsible for these pregnancies are left to walk on the streets freely. This situation is unfair and I think we really need to pay attention to the men who contribute to these teenage pregnancies in our society.

Mr Speaker, on this note, I call on the Government, faith-based organisations and our communities to increase education in our various schools to make sure that young girls are really educated, as well as the boys. Mr Speaker, I have four boys and I have already started schooling them on issues like this, so that they will not bring any teenage child into my house and impregnating them. They dare not try that in my house. [*Uproar*]

Mr Speaker, if we fail to act now on this issue, we will be trapped in a situation where young girls will be robbed of their future and trapped in cycles of poverty and social hardships. Thus, this situation must be addressed. I call upon the Government, traditional leaders, parents and all our communities to join hands in educating our children and to train the girl and boy child to both share the responsibility of issues on teenage pregnancy.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to commend my Colleague, Mrs Racheal Owusuah, Hon Member for the Dormaa East Constituency, for bringing

such an important issue to the fore. Looking at the Hon Minister for Gender, Children and Social Protection from here, I believe that she will take this matter up and we will all work and join hands on this. I am also encouraging all female MPs to model our young girls in our constituencies, so that we can have a lot of young girls coming up, standing and representing us from our various constituencies in the few generations that lie ahead of us.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I am really grateful for the opportunity to contribute to this issue. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member for Akuapem South.

Let me now go to Rev Ntoso.

Rev Helen Adjoa Ntoso (NDC — Krachi West): Mr Speaker, I thank Hon Rachael Owusuah for this Statement that is very urgent, and as a nation, we have got to do something about it.

2.28 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the issue of teenage pregnancy is a complex issue. It is a combination of factors, and that includes social and economic factors, which also includes lack of parental care, peer pressure, poverty, and inadequate knowledge about sexual health. Mr Speaker, gone are the days where National Commission on Civic Education (NCCE) were given the opportunity to educate children and the public about sexual health. These days,

what do we see? Because of lack of resources, they are not able to do that. Also, our children, these girls and boys are involved in drug abuse. It is also a contributing factor to teenage pregnancy.

Then, we also have lack of parental care. It is a responsibility of Government, parents, and the individual that have got to come together to make sure that we have a conducive environment for these children. Because if we have a conducive environment for these children, they will not be lured into picking petty sums of moneys from men who are so irresponsible, some of whom even go for these small girls. These things will, you know, be prevented.

Mr Speaker, also, if you go to the communities—Her community is not different from what happens in other communities. The Committee on Gender, Children and Social Welfare had the opportunity to go to the Central Region, and the Queen Mothers met with us, and they were so unhappy about the rate at which they were recording teenage pregnancy in the Central Region. It is also as a result of—I have to say that the computer placement that was being practiced where girls were posted to places far from where their parents are, and they were compelled to be day students. So these children, when they run out of their food items and they go to town, they are compelled to take GH¢20.00 from irresponsible guys, to be able to feed themselves. I am happy that the new Minister for Education is asking the children to actually choose schools that they want to attend. I pray that the children will be sent to schools

that will be closer to their parents, so that the parents will be able to monitor the children as to when they go out and come in.

Mr Speaker, I also pray that Government will also take responsibility of helping parents who are in poor areas, because poverty can lure one into doing what the person is not supposed to do.

I also encourage District Assemblies to also come out with bylaws that will prevent these children from going out after 6.00 p.m. where at funerals, you see these children dancing and the parents are not there.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Chief Whip is saying that I should wrap up. On this note, I pray that we all come together as one people to be able to help children in vulnerable areas.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, I will comment on the last two Statements, since we did not comment on the Statement made by Hon John Darko.

Mr Speaker, the issue of energy transitioning is really key, and I have to commend my Brother for making such a Statement. Mr Speaker, energy transitioning —

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Which one are you commenting on?

Mr Fokuo: I am commenting on the last two Statements, the one made by Hon John Darko and then the one that has just been made, because we did not exhaust ours on that Statement. I will comment on the two Statements.

Mr Speaker, energy transitioning is happening at a fast pace across the world, and I believe Ghana, we need to be intentional to be part, otherwise, we will be left behind. Mr Speaker, energy transitioning means saving the environment. It means being efficient with the resources that we have. It means improving on our health, because we will be releasing less carbon mono-oxide into the environment when we transition from combustion energy to the renewable energy that we have.

Mr Speaker, more specifically to the Statement, the issue of our mechanics not having the needed skills to work on EVs, that is electric vehicles. The issue is, a lot of the mechanics that we have now, learnt their skill using combustion energy, but now we have electric vehicles coming into the market, and the issue is how do we cope? How would our mechanics transition to be able to work on electric vehicles?

Mr Speaker, if you think about it, for new mechanics-to-be, we can take them through the TVET system and train them, but the question is what about those who are already in the trade, or already acquired the combustion technology? What do we do with them?

Some of them are aged already, so they will struggle to go through the TVET system. How do we get them trained to be able to work on EVs? Mr Speaker, the suggestion is that Government could come on board to help forge some collaborations between the automakers through their dealerships and the various mechanic hubs that we have in this country.

So, in the specific case that was put across by Hon John Darko, we could have some of the mechanics from, let us say, Suame, collaborating with some automakers for training, either done here locally, or elsewhere; whichever is convenient. And when this technology is acquired, I believe they can then share among their colleagues as they come back to the hubs. This could be replicated across the country, being Abossey Okai or wherever that we need to train our mechanics.

Mr Speaker, this is urgent. Otherwise, we do not know how we are going to maintain the EVs that are coming into the market. Yesterday, I listened to the Minister for Energy and Green Transition. As he made his presentation, he said Government going forward is going to import some EVs to be given to government officials. So you ask yourself, if now it is becoming a government policy to bring in EVs to government officials, how are we going to maintain these EVs? Mr Speaker, it is an urgent issue, and I believe if we forge collaborations, we will be able to train our mechanics to acquire the new skills.

Mr Speaker, on the Statement made by my Hon Lady, I believe the subject of

teenage pregnancy is a major issue. The major issue there is lack of education, and education not necessarily being formal education, going to learn whichever subject, but education in that particular subject of teenage pregnancy and what to know in order not to fall a victim or to fall into traps.

Mr Speaker, I believe that such education should not be limited to just the teenagers, but should be extended to parents, families, guardians and people that are close to said teenagers, to be able to share knowledge with said teenagers. Because they are young with all the exuberance, they want to try new things and so on. They see things on social media and they want to try and a whole lot of risks around them. So, I believe education is the way to go. Education, like I said, not only to them, but to the people around them who are moulding them. And I believe if we have this going out to them and the people around them, we will be halfway addressing the issue of teenage pregnancy.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

2.38 p.m.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Comfort Doyoe?

First Deputy Majority Whip (Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe): I thank you, Mr Speaker for the opportunity to add my voice and I would like to thank the maker of the Statement and urge all

Ghanaians to be careful when it comes to their baby girls.

Mr Speaker, the moment one gives birth to a baby girl, she will reach puberty age from 9 years upwards and she will start menstruating. Then quickly you should know you have a fine baby girl because the “bulbs” will start coming. From there, one has to start guiding his or her baby girl. Be honest with the baby girl and tell her that the “small thing” they see with the boys is dangerous, so they should not go close to it. But we would not tell our baby girls and the men will lure them as if it is for fun. They do not know; some of the girls are naive and they do not even know that that thing can impregnate them. They do not even understand why women are pregnant. We should tell them the truth as to what get women get pregnant. We should tell that it is through that thing called penis that women get pregnant, so they should not joke with it. They should not go close to it. They should focus on their education.

Mr Speaker, when they get pregnant, we should do not ignore them. We should bring them closer. At times, we ignore them because they are pregnant and it is not a teenage boy who will make her pregnant. It is a full-grown man who will make her pregnant and the same man, as her father in the house, will start ignoring that baby girl. We are pleading that parents give them the real education. We should tell them what it is that that thing is not for fun and it is for baby making. So, if they go closer, they will get pregnant and will make babies.

So, if they are not ready for babies, they should do not go closer. That is what my mother told me. So, when I see a man, I run— [**Some Members:** *Ei!*]— When I was young, my mother even told me that if a man touches me, I will get pregnant. So, I even thought if he touched me like this, I would get pregnant. So, if I see a man coming, I run and I kept running until I got to understand that it is not just touching, but they will lure you to their house and they will make you pregnant. Let us be fair to our baby girls.

Please, Mr Speaker, when they get pregnant, they have not ended their life; it is not a life sentence. They can still make it, so we should just allow them to have their peace, give birth, take that baby from them and allow them to go back to school. Education has no end. Recently, when Mr Speaker announced a scholarship here, I have even been interested and I want to go back to school.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Interested in what?

Ms Cudjoe: I have been interested in education and I want to go back and read. I am interested. So, if at my age, I still have interest in education, at that teenage age, parents should just take the baby and allow her back to the classroom or she could go and learn a trade. She can still make it. It does not end there. There is perception that if a girl is pregnant, it is a taboo. So, the stigmatisation that starts from there should stop. Let us help and educate them. We should catch them young. From nine years, we should start teaching the girls. At 13 years, they will

be growing big, so we should start teaching them that this is how things work, so that they do not fall victims. A lot of them are victims because they do not understand the whole thing. So they get pregnant before they realise that what they were playing with was not for fun, but it was something dangerous that can damage their future.

So, parents, we are pleading. Be honest with your baby girls. They are growing big and they are growing nice. Guide them and let them have the right tutorial in the house so that they do not fall victim.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompseh): Mr Speaker, may you permit me to contribute to the Statement made by Hon Darko on the Energy Transition.

I commend him highly and I wish to, from the outset, say that, Mr Speaker, right from the Paris Agreement, the concerns and the narrative has changed. We have signed on to the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), the Protocol on Kyoto and all the relevant conventions on the environment have been signed. Mr Speaker, we are quick to sign these conventions, but implementation has always come in its wake as a challenge.

I think, generally, the Statement by the Hon Member focused on the general

output on Energy Transition, reduction of carbon credit and the carbon footprint, and then he zeroed in on electric vehicles (EVs). Mr Speaker, the need for EVs is not lost on us. In fact, we have a policy on electronic vehicles as a country and we should be adverting our minds as to how its enforcement and implementation come up. Under the renewable concerns, the world now has what we call the rare minerals, thus, bauxite, lithium, *et cetera*.

Mr Speaker, Indonesia is producing its own solar panels because experts have said that close to 70 per cent of the raw materials needed for the production of these solar panels, batteries, mobile phones come from these rare minerals and many years after the discovery of these traditional minerals, gold and the likes, these rare minerals have become so important and Africa has a lot of it. Ghana has a lot of it. We should be leveraging on these rare minerals and make Africa important in the energy transition.

We lost out on the industrial transition and a number of transitions as a continent. But the transition to renewable energy, Africa cannot be left out because of the rare mineral deposits that we have. We have a lot of lithium; Congo, Ghana and other countries across the West Africa sub-region have them in commercial quantities and this is where I think the discussion should focus on.

On the EVs, the Ministry of Transport should be telling us what the preparations and works are towards the enforcement of the EV policy, thus, charging outlets. We cannot talk about

EVs when these charging outlets are not being developed. We cannot talk about EVs when the academia is missing. What is academia doing about it? We cannot talk about EVs when car garages and mechanics are not being tuned in terms of the preparation. So, when we import these EVs or even when we manufacture these EVs and they are faulty, who are the people who would resolve them? So, these are fundamentals and I think that it is not beyond us at all.

Mr Speaker, you are not a fan of referrers, especially in the face of the preponderance of referrers that are outstanding. I am not sure if I make an application for you to refer this matter, you would accede to my request.

2.48 p.m.

We hope the Minister for Transport and the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology would stay current and also carry this House along in the context of this subject matter and Ghana cannot be left out. We can borrow lessons—We do not need to reinvent anything. Indonesia has set the tone. Kenya, for instance, has liberalised their energy sector so much that private entities have been given the opportunity and have been facilitated to import these panels and a lot of these panels are manufactured within. So, I think we should take a cue from all these happenings and advise ourselves as a country.

Mr Speaker, I thank you and I am grateful.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Majority Leadership?

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan: Mr Speaker, I rise to contribute to all the Statements, as we are doing an omnibus; we will comment on a couple of the Statements ably made by three Members of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, the green transition is already here. Across the world, we have over 40 million of these EVs that are driving around. In Ghana, we have over 20,000 of the EVs also here. The transition has begun and we need to transition all the areas that will, basically, support having this new technology.

I do not think that the fact that we are going to have EVs means that we are going to be losing jobs. We will only do so if we do not retool and retrain the mechanics that we are worried might lose their jobs. Mr Speaker, at the end of the day, if, just for instance, we have one million cars in this country, probably more than that, and they are on fossil fuel, Mr Speaker, if we go on green transition in terms of having the EV, we will still have a million cars. The million that was on fossil fuel will need to be repaired or they are being repaired at the moment so will the new one million that will also come if we replace these vehicles with EVs.

So, we have to be ahead of the curve and being ahead of the curve is making sure that we are retooling our mechanics

and they are getting the requisite training that they need to be able to repair these cars because they still will be repaired. The only difference is that they will go on a different fuel. One will be on electrical and the current ones we have will, basically, be on fossil fuel.

Mr Speaker, the problem is bigger than that. Because, as the world moves away into the new technology, it means that the old technology that we have— For instance, Ghana has joined the oil producing nations as far as Africa is concerned. We produce fossil fuel here which means that if all the vehicles should be moving and we no longer have a need for fossil fuel, our revenues that we get from oil will be going down. The question should be, how are we going to replace the revenues that we get from fossil fuel if we are no longer exporting them or using it ourselves domestically?

Mr Speaker, we should embrace the future and not be skeptical about it that things will be bad. Mr Speaker, things will only be bad if we do not embrace this new technology and make sure that we have actually trained people to take advantage of it. On the contrary, the new technology will rather bring opportunities into new areas that we will benefit from. As the Minority Chief Whip rightly said, a lot of these things that are going to happen to us with this new technology in terms of our energy space, which is actually in abundance here in Africa. Everything that the new technology involves with this green transition is actually here. In fact, we are the world suppliers of these kinds of things. So, we can use them domestically to

manufacture our own cars and to produce energy, whether it is hydro, wind energy or what have you. It will be of advantage to us and we will be able to create more jobs ourselves from it. We will also be able to earn more export revenue if we have them in abundance here and we are exporting them.

I do not think that we should be too worried, but we should rather position ourselves in such a way that we take advantage, so we do not lose out, as the Minority Chief Whip said, as we have lost out in many new technologies and many new developments in the world.

Mr Speaker, last but not least, on the teenage pregnancy, as many contributors have said, education is key. I remember when you and I were in school, we were taught human biology, which obviously teaches some of these things, so that our kids will be aware of what the implications will be if they get into certain acts and that they would have kids and that sort of thing. So, Mr Speaker, it is the education and the awareness for our kids.

Secondly, there is the issue of idleness. If kids are idle, do not continue their education and are not trained to be in a gainful employment, the idle hands will play into many things. So, Mr Speaker, these are the things that we need to do. And then, of course, when our kids become pregnant, we do not abandon them that they have got themselves into that problem, so they should deal with it. We should remember first that they are kids and they need all the support they can get, so that if they

have to have these babies, they can get the support from the parents and to get these kids back to school again, either to study or to be trained to do something.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I thank you very much and I thank the makers of this Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Let me thank the makers and the contributors of the Statement.

Hon Members, we bring Statement time to a close and let me ask you to indulge me to introduce our guests' colleagues from our sister Parliament in Kenya at the Speaker's Gallery and they are here—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let me pray you to take one more Statement, which also fell in the category of the long-standing ones, in the name of Hon Afrah Gyeke, so that she could also make her Statement today on trade.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, let me introduce my guests first.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: So, they are here; I understand they came to meet the Committee on Foreign Affairs Committee and Regional Integration. So, they are being led by Hon Irene Nyakerario Mayaka. I hope I have pronounced the name well. She is the leader of the delegation. We also have

Hon Naisula Lesuuda, who is also a Member of Parliament. Then, we have Christine Owuor, who is a member from the World Bank, Kenya. We also have Deborah Oyugah, who is an educationist and Bernard Toroitich, a clerk to the Committee. [*Hear! Hear!*]

2.58 p.m.

I hope I was able to mention your names well. Very well. You are welcome and we wish you a fruitful stay in Ghana.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: My respected Majority Chief Whip just mounted an application that we should do an additional Statement. Actually, he was not in the House; we have adopted a Business Statement for the ensuing week—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: The application is for today.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Today, their Side has presented two Statements already. There was one on child abuse and teenage pregnancy. We have presented just one, so he should bear in mind that admission and presentation of Statements is not done based on ratio. However, we also have a long list of Statements. Mr Speaker, we have outstanding Statements that have not been read, so if it is the case that he wants to do another one, there is no problem, but we will also do one. So, it will be one from their Side and one from our Side, then we will be fine.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I was here when we adopted the Business

Statement for next week and, indeed, I was here when my Hon Brother was on his feet and made long contributions when the Business Statement was read. He did not make me out, but I was here.

Mr Speaker, my plea is that when I came, I was informed that four Statements had been agreed to be taken today. They were part of the long-standing Statements, so this particular one is part of it. If my Hon Brother says that we should take an additional one from the Minority Side, I am all for it. The most important thing is that—Mr Speaker, the Statements are piling up and suddenly, we have a tall list of Statements such as we have for Questions.

When the opportunity presents itself like this, even though we want to go, we can allow the Member to make the Statement and rather limit the comments that Members would make because we do not have a heavy Business today, then we can make some progress.

My Speaker, let me rather agree to the proposal of my Hon Brother, Mr Annoh-Dompreh. In support of my application, I agree that we take an additional one from his Side, but limit the comments, then we can bring the proceedings of today to an end.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I was almost agreeing and I just recollected that today is actually Friday. Mr Speaker, the New Patriotic Party (NPP), the party waiting to come to government, has its congress—Because of our congress tomorrow, which is a very important event—The organisation

of parties, as you all know, is important, because it is the parties that will govern the country and very soon, they will pack bag and baggage and we would take over. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Speaker, we are going for congress and it is early tomorrow morning, so may I plead with my Colleagues that since we are sitting on Monday, we defer these Statements and take them on Monday. I know he has some Papers he wants to lay; let us lay those Papers and then call it a day. Today is Friday. Mr Speaker, I implore you to tell him to jettison his application and then we can make progress.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the long and short is that let us take the Statement. The NPP will surely have their congress, but I am reliably informed that there is an injunction—*[Interruption]*—No, I am reliably informed. I have not seen the process, but I have been informed that there is an injunctive process—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Dafeamekpor, that is not your case.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, whatever it is, may I pray that we take the Statements.

Mr Annoh- Dompreeh: Mr Speaker, I think we should lay the Papers because on Monday, if you look at the proposed—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: I am told the Papers on the Order Paper *Addendum* cannot be laid, is that the case?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my information is that there are some errors in terms of the framing of the names of the Instruments, so we want to take the opportunity to correct them so that Monday, when we come, they can be taken. There are 30 of them. We have taken five, pending the 30, so Monday, we can take them, but we also have—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Are you saying that we are taking five out of the 30?

Mr Dafeamekpor: No, we have taken the five already. My information is that we have taken the five, Mr Speaker, let us take the Statement, then we can break—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, I will take the Statement and just one contribution from each Side. If there is somebody here, I will also allow that. So, I will take one from here.

Yes?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I thought he said that admissibility of Statement is not subject to the ratio.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: My Hon Brother, you have the floor now, let me hear you.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is rather your Hon Sister, Mrs Afrah Gyekye.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have the floor now. Let us hear you.

STATEMENTS

Ghana's Garment Industry

Mrs Nasira Afrah Gyekye (NDC — Sekyere Afram Plains): I am grateful for the opportunity, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise today to draw the attention of this esteemed House to the neglect of the garment industry of Ghana, an industry brimming with potential to transform our economy, create jobs, and empower our youth and women, while celebrating our rich cultural heritage.

Globally, this industry involves the designing, production, marketing and distribution of clothing with the artistry of design for both local and international markets. It is a vibrant ecosystem involving designers, manufacturers, suppliers, retailers and consumers.

Mr Speaker, the garment industry in Ghana is marked by both traditional and modern artistry. Our garments like the *Kente* and *Fugu* are not just fabrics, they embody our cultural identity and heritage, and are recognised both internationally and locally. Yet, the influx of cheap imported clothing, coupled with limited local production has seen the contribution of our industry to GDP drop from a whopping 6.5 per

cent in the 1970s to just under 1 per cent today.

However, Mr Speaker, this sector is poised to be the catalyst for socio-economic transformation. With targeted government support, private sector participation, international partnership and innovative design, we can restore the garment industry as a strong dynamic pillar of our economy. Thankfully, we are now witnessing a revitalisation of the garment industry fuelled by technology, social media, creative enterprise and skills development.

Mr Speaker, this sector is a crucial component of the vision of the Government of a 24-Hour Economy, allowing production and services to operate continuously, thereby generating more jobs and enhancing productivity. The garment industry is ideally suited for this policy, fostering on going manufacturing, warehousing, logistics and export operations across our region.

This industry holds the incredible potential to integrate tourism development in our country. Ghana can attract international visitors by creating garment tourism villages, traditional textile museums and annual fashion shows while promoting our unique identity. Mr Speaker, we must harness our rich cultural access to create immersive cultural and tourism experiences that blend fashion, heritage and travel.

Mr Speaker, the garment sectors potential to empower women and youth is undeniable.

3.08 p.m.

Globally, it employs millions, especially women, providing them with skills building and entrepreneurship opportunities. We can replicate this with strategic investments in Ghana, particularly, in rural areas like my Constituency, Sekyere Afram Plains, where opportunities are limited. Investing in training, equipment and inclusive workspaces can empower women and young people to emerge as leaders and innovators within this sector.

Mr Speaker, the Government's National Apprenticeship Programme and Adwumawura Programme, which were recently launched, present timely avenues for this transformation. We can cultivate a skilled workforce ready to meet domestic and global demand by aligning them with garment production and creative industries. Each trained apprentice will secure a good job and become a potential job creator and entrepreneur, amplifying our impact in empowering youths to be self-employed. Ghana possesses significant competitive advantages like skilled labour, proximity to raw materials, a burgeoning fashion economy and access to the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA). With consistent policies, infrastructure investment and value chain integration, we can position Ghana as a leading hub for garment manufacturing and export in West Africa.

Mr Speaker, I propose that this Government, in partnership with the private sector and development partners, establish a garment factory in each of

Ghana's 16 regions, not merely as production centres, but as a hub for training and empowerment. This initiative, if adopted by the Mahama-Opoku-Agyemang Administration, will decentralise economic activity, curb rural-urban migration and foster inclusive economic development.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, revitalising Ghana's garment industry presents not just an economic obligation, but a national opportunity to create jobs, honour our cultural heritage, empower our youth and women and showcase the promise of a government that stands for every Ghanaian. Let us unite to research this garment industry. As an Ashanti would say, "*se Ghana beye yie a, efiri yen ara*" to wit Ghana's success depends on our collective efforts as citizens.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Alexander Roosevelt Hottordze (NDC — Central Tongu): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, let me use the opportunity to thank the maker of this Statement, because it is very important, looking at the 24-Hour Economy that is about to be rolled out.

Mr Speaker, it is a fact that this particular sub-sector is beaming with the potential to transform our economy, create a lot of jobs for our youth and women, and also give us the opportunity to celebrate our own culture, as she has indicated. Mr Speaker, the problem with

this sector is that a lot of the industries are facing unhealthy competition from the outside world. This unhealthy competition is triggered by intensified globalisation that has given the opportunity to the foreign companies to produce this kind of inferior goods and flood them with our markets. According to Decker and others (2006); Harvey, (2004); Rishi and Brindley, (2000), this particular sector faced a lot of challenges. The high cost of production triggered by power, electricity, outdated production technology, lack of access to capital, issues with supply chain, and the nature of the dyes that they used and managerial capabilities have affected these factories over the years.

Mr Speaker, let me use the opportunity to give some data. In the 1970s, around 1977 to be precise, this particular sector employed 25,000 people, and 129 yards of fabric were being printed a year. But this reduced to 46,000 in 1995, and the number of people it was employing reduced to 7,000. In 2000, they could only employ 5,000 people, and 65 million yards were produced. In 2005, it was worse; they employed only 2,961 people and they produced only 39 million yards.

Mr Speaker, the card manufacturing industry and others are doing very well in this country. They have employed a lot of our young people, and they have been producing garment for outside market and for domestic consumption. Research by Kotey and Abor (2011), showed that local consumers in Ghanaian markets prefer the locally manufactured fabrics rather than the foreign ones that are

imported into this country. If that is the case, why not do anything to protect this industry? There is a need for us to do a lot.

I am happy to inform the House that just last week, as a result of President Mahama's idea of the 24-Hour Economy, the local manufacturers in this particular area met the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry. Their meeting was to ensure that Government comes out with a policy that will protect them and depend solely on local content so that they could boost the economy of this country— Like all these school uniforms, soldiers' apparel, police apparel, all will be sewn in this country—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Mr Hottordze: And the money will remain in this country. So, I pray that we realise that dream and with the 24-Hour Economy, Ghana will come back to life again.

Thank you so much.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Hajia, you have spoken today, so please be brief.

Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah (NDC — Salaga South): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. And I know you have indulged me because I come here every day wearing the cloth, the Ghanaian fabric, the garment, which is peculiar to Ghana.

Mr Speaker, I want to start by celebrating the Hon Member for Sekyere Afram Plains for this very insightful Statement. Mr Speaker, the author of the Statement made reference to our culture and our tradition and implored all of us to see the garment as a celebration and a reflection of who we are.

Mr Speaker, data has shown that the industry from the 70s to now is going down. Mr Speaker, if we produce the cloths in Ghana and we do not wear them, I do not know who will wear the cloth for us. So, Mr Speaker, it starts with us. I remember there was a time when we had Friday wear, which was compulsory for every public servant and every civil servant to wear made in Ghana.

Mr Speaker, just this afternoon, I encountered two of my Colleagues in the lift, and they were in beautiful smocks. I did not know about this Statement, but I said to them that it looks like the men have declared today a smock day. A lot of the men I have seen in the Chamber are in smock, and the smocks are indeed beautiful.

3.18 p.m.

Mr Speaker, we need to take it upon ourselves. We need to provide the first market for this industry. We need to showcase what we have. Fortunately, for us, it is beautiful; it is pretty and it is cute.

Mr Speaker, for seven years when I served as Head of Information and Minister Counsellor at our Mission in London, I wore only the cloth made from Ghana. It was packaged in suitcases and

sent over to me in London and I wore it every day and everywhere.

Mr Speaker, I want to encourage all of us to let this Statement be an inspiration to us and to wear made in Ghana. When we do that the designers and manufacturers of this country will feel proud and encouraged to continue doing what they do.

Mr Speaker, I would like to thank you for the opportunity, but before I sit, I want to congratulate Hon Nasira for such a wonderful Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you so much.

Hon Deputy Minister, we are already behind time, so I will invite Hon Jerry to read his Statement.

International Day of Justice, 2025

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib (NPP — Weija-Gbawe): Mr Speaker, I have this Statement that was supposed to have been delivered yesterday, but I still believe that, within the period, it is still an important Statement.

Mr Speaker, I rise today to make a Statement in recognition of the International Day of Justice which was observed globally yesterday, 17th July, under the theme, “Accountability and Respect for Law”. Mr Speaker, this year marks the 27th anniversary of the adoption of the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court (ICC), a historic milestone that established the first permanent international criminal

court dedicated to ending impunity for the most serious crimes of concern to the international community.

As we observe this International Day of Justice, we reflect on the unwavering commitment of Ghana to the rule of law, both domestically and internationally, and our role in advancing justice for all humanity.

Mr Speaker, the significance of this day extends beyond mere commemoration to the rule of law both domestically and internationally and our role in advancing justice for all humanity. The significance of this day extends beyond commemoration; it serves as a powerful reminder that justice transcends national boundaries and that the fight against impunity requires collective action from the global community. The theme, “Accountability and Respect for Law”, resonates deeply with democratic aspirations of Ghana and our ongoing journey toward a more just society.

Mr Speaker, the establishment of the International Criminal Court (ICC) represents a paradigm shift in international law, moving from a system where sovereignty could shield perpetrators of mass atrocities to one where individual accountability takes precedence. This transformation embodies the very essence of our theme that no one, regardless of position or power, should be above the law.

Mr Speaker, accountability, as demonstrated by the International Criminal Court, means that those who commit the grievous crimes against

humanity must face justice. Respect for law, the complementary aspect of our theme, ensures that legal frameworks are not merely theoretical constructs but living instruments that govern behaviour and protect the vulnerable.

Mr Speaker, legal system of Ghana represents a complex tapestry of legal traditions, reflecting our colonial history and indigenous practices. As noted by the Judicial Service of Ghana, the legal system of Ghana was built on a foundation of received Anglo-Saxon common law, statutory law and other documents with an enduring body of largely unwritten customary usages and practices that remain a contextual feature of the modern legal system of Ghana.

This diverse legal heritage underscores the importance of respecting all forms of law within our jurisdiction. True respect for law means acknowledging that justice can emerge from various legal traditions, while ensuring that these traditions align with fundamental human rights principles.

Mr Speaker, since the restoration of constitutional democracy in 1993, Ghana has made significant strides in strengthening the rule of law, according to the Africa Governance Monitoring and Advocacy Project (AfriMAP). The country has witnessed many positive developments since the restoration of civilian rule in 1993, including improvements in the administration of law and justice. These improvements reflect our growing understanding that accountability is not merely about punishment, but about creating systems

that prevent abuse of power and ensure transparent governance.

Mr Speaker, as parliamentarians, we bear a special responsibility in advancing the course of justice, particularly in embodying the principles of accountability and respect for law. The Parliament of Ghana serves as the primary institution for lawmaking, oversight and representation, making it central to any efforts to strengthen the rule of law. Our role extends beyond simply passing laws. We must ensure that legislation is crafted with justice and human rights principles at its core.

Mr Speaker, the accountability function of Parliament manifests through rigorous oversight of the Executive, ensuring that government policies and actions comply with legal standards. We must demonstrate respect for law by subjecting ourselves to the same legal standards we expect of others and by creating laws that are fair, just and responsive to the needs of our constituents.

Mr Speaker, the advancement of justice is not solely the responsibility of government institutions. Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), legal practitioners, academic institutions and ordinary citizens all have vital roles to play in promoting justice and the rule of law. CSOs serve as watch dogs, advocates and service providers helping to ensure that justice institutions remain accountable to the people they serve.

Mr Speaker, legal practitioners have a professional obligation to uphold the highest standards of legal practice and to

ensure that justice is accessible to all. They serve as guardians of respect for law by maintaining professional ethics and advocating for their clients within the bounds of legal propriety.

As we commemorate the International Day of Justice, we must recommit ourselves to the pursuit of a more just society, grounded in accountability and respect for law. This requires sustained efforts across multiple fronts, including strengthening institutions, promoting legal education and awareness, embracing technology and innovation, and fostering inclusive justice.

Mr Speaker, we must continue to invest in building strong, independent and effective institutions that embody accountability in their operations and command respect through their fairness and effectiveness. This includes providing adequate resources, improving infrastructure and ensuring that our institutions have the capacity to deliver timely and fair justice.

The International Day of Justice reminds us that the pursuit of justice is both a global endeavour and a local responsibility. For Ghana, this day represents an opportunity to reflect on our progress, acknowledge our challenges, and renew our commitment to build a more just society. As we move forward, we must remember that justice is not a destination but a journey. It requires the sustained commitment of all stakeholders, governments, civil society and citizens.

Mr Speaker, I first of all call upon the Government of Ghana (GoG) to demonstrate unwavering commitment to strengthening our justice institutions through increased budgetary allocations, comprehensive justice sector reforms and the implementation of policies that ensure equal access to justice for all. Government must lead by example in demonstrating accountability and respect for law in all actions and decisions.

Furthermore, to my esteemed Colleagues in Parliament, I call upon us to recognise our sacred duty as custodians of the law and guardians of democratic principles.

3.28 p.m.

We must commit to passing legislation that opposes human rights, strengthens the rule of law, and ensures that our legal framework remains responsive to the evolving needs of our society.

Lastly, to our esteemed members of the Judiciary, I call upon them to continue upholding the highest standards of judicial independence, integrity, and impartiality. The Judiciary remains the final arbiter of justice in our democracy and citizens must have unwavering confidence in its ability to deliver fair and timely justice.

Mr Speaker, let us use this day to recommit ourselves to the cause of justice, knowing that our efforts today will shape the Ghana we leave for future generations. May the principles of accountability and respect for law guide our actions as we work together to build

a more just and equitable society for all Ghanaians.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for allowing me to make this Statement.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will take one comment from each Side and then we would bring proceedings to a close.

Yes, Hon Tampuli?

Mr Alhassan Tampuli Sulemana (NPP — Gushegu): Mr Speaker, I rise to make a few remarks on the Statement that has been ably delivered by the Hon Second Deputy Minority Whip and distinguished Member for the good people of Weiya/Gbawe.

Mr Speaker, the end results of principles such as rule of law, constitutionalism, separation of powers and all those wonderful superlatives is respect for the fundamental human rights and freedoms of our people.

Mr Speaker, as rightly said by the maker of the Statement, in Article 11 of the 1992 Constitution, one would find the hierarchy of laws: the Constitution, enactments, instruments, customary law, common law, orders, and so on. All of these would come to nothing if the individual does not enjoy any liberties.

Mr Speaker, this takes us to matters within Chapter 5 of our Constitution, which deals with fundamental human rights and it is very pleasing to know that this House has come of age. Currently, we have a Committee on Human Rights

that have been halved from the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs. The rights of the citizens would be better enhanced if we give fidelity to provisions in the Constitution such as Articles 14 and 19, which guarantee fair trial for individuals. So, a person is picked up, the Miranda rights is read to them, taken through the process and sent before a court of law within a matter of 48 hours. What we have come to know is that some security institutions say that they must take one after 48 hours. The law says within 48 hours, so if a person is taken into custody, it starts to reason that security officers should be reckoning the dates and by the time 48 hours extends, they should be able to take the person to a court of competent jurisdiction. But what we have come to realise is that, in some instances, bail is granted, but the terms are too onerous.

Mr Speaker, these do not accord with the kind of freedoms that we expect that an individual in the country enjoys. Such onerous bail terms, one way or the other, says that they want to continue to hold the person in custody. We must all advert our minds to the provisions of the 1992 Constitution that provides for us to give the accused person or the person of interest or a suspect the benefits of doubts, in which case, it provides that a person is presumed innocent until he is convicted by a court of competent jurisdiction or he himself had admitted to committing some crime.

Mr Speaker, with all of these things, we have to come back and rededicate ourselves to what would continue to nourish this our constitutional

democracy that we have given to ourselves since 1993. Indeed, Mr Speaker, this is the longest spell that we have ever had since the First Republic. I believe that we all have a duty to continue to do our best to keep ourselves in track.

Mr Speaker, I thank the maker of the Statement and I appreciate the opportunity to make this contribution.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker:
Lastly, let me hear the—

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, let me thank the maker of the Statement, who is bringing our attention to our parliamentary jurisprudence and the practice of constitutionalism. Right from the First Republic and where we are as a country, we need to pat ourselves on the shoulder; mainly, because more often than not, we have overly focused on the negatives. The positives must be celebrated as well.

Of course, there are regrettable moments right from the 1960 Constitution. We have had some very bad moments, but clearly, we have lived on as a Republic and have showed improvement; however incremental it has been, we have shown improvement. In the Third Republican, there was the exercise of clear separation of powers between the Executive and the Legislature.

Mr Speaker, again, during the 1979 Constitution, we had the opportunity where the then Minority Leader was a Member of the Council of State and it

was for a very good reason. Mr Speaker, right from the International Bill of Rights of the United Nations (UN), which has found reflection in our Chapter 5 and 6 of our Constitution, particularly Chapter 6, Directive Principle of State Policy. In other jurisdictions such as Nigeria, which is just nearby, the Directive Principle of the State Policy, is justiciable. We have captured very beautiful provisions. The Directive Principle of State Policy is supposed to be a good guide to the Judiciary, the Executive and the Legislature. These are beautiful in the books, yet we cannot enforce them. A country like Kenya has tested all provisions in their Constitution.

Mr Speaker, we are always in a hurry to put together a creature to look at our Constitution. We have often lacked the confidence to make the necessary amendment to our Constitution. I am aware the President has put together another body. I hope we will be confident to do what we have to do. Mr Tampuli, my respected Colleague, referenced Article 14 and 19, particularly Article 14 which deals with rights, arrest, detention and our liberties. These are things that we should teach our kids at school and we should relate to them practically.

Mr Speaker, I think these are the things that will make the difference while we seek to nurture our democracy. Our democracy has come to stay and the very ingredient that nurtures our democracy is the rule of law and the Constitution and we should be seen to be consolidating the Constitution.

3.38 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I know we are constrained with time and already, the NPP will be gathering tomorrow at our congress, so I will end it here and thank you for the kind opportunity. I am grateful, Mr Speaker.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Majority Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let me commend the maker of this important Statement. Reading the title of the Statement, it is in commemoration of the International Day of Justice. The venerable Rev Martin Luther King, of blessed memory, the legend and apostle of civil rights in the world, not only limited to America alone but in the Western Hemisphere, in modern democracies, said, "Injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere".

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Take that statement again. Injustice?

Mr Dafeamekpor: "Injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere", so where infractions of injustice occur anywhere in the world, then the possibility of justice existing everywhere else becomes threatened. It is such a profound statement that governs modern jurisprudence and constitutionalism. Mr Speaker, underpinning constitutional rule is the call for justice. Justice may happen whether we like it or not, but, as a people, we must strive for it.

Mr Speaker, three days ago, at an international seminar, another very profound statement was made. The person said, “sometimes the law gets in the way of justice”, and it is true. People can use the law to frustrate justice from being administered. So, as my Hon Brother has called on this House to commemorate this day, we, as parliamentarians, must be the avant-garde of ensuring that justice prevails in our various communities.

Meting out instant justice to people when they are perceived to have committed some wrong must, at all times, be avoided. Instant justice must be avoided because that is not justice. There is a procedure provided under law in pursuance of which justice can be ensured. Mr Speaker, homes of people are demolished unlawfully. When they seek justice, it takes forever. Even the state has occasioned injustice to people.

Mr Speaker, let me use the opportunity to speak about the hundreds of families and paramountcies who lost their lands during the construction of the Volta Dam. The dam is benefiting the state, but the people who lost their lands have been chasing their compensations till date. So, I appreciate it and I would like to commend my Hon Brother once more for this important Statement.

It is a Statement that should keep guiding us in all that we do. Even on the Floor, we must be seen to be ensuring that justice prevails at all times. Mr Speaker, even when you are sitting, we must not make your work difficult because you need to administer justice in

how you manage the House. If we make the work so difficult for you, you are placed in a situation where you are seen not to administer justice, but you must discipline in order to ensure that justice prevails.

So, Mr Speaker, I thank you for admitting this Statement. There were issues regarding how many we could take, but I am happy that finally, when this Statement was taken, it became a Statement that befits the status of being the last Statement for today, being the last day of the week.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

Hon Members, we will bring Statements time to a close. I would like to thank you for your cooperation. We will bring proceedings to a close.

Hon Majority Chief Whip, may you move the Motion for us to adjourn.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, precisely so. In the absence of any further Business, I beg to move that the proceedings of today be brought to an end and the House be adjourned accordingly.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, I see my mentor in the Chamber. He is a man of justice. For such an important Statement on justice, Mr Speaker, I pray that you indulge him. I know he does not need to read. He is a walking justice. Yes, he is a man of profound independence.

Mr Speaker, with these words, my prayer is that you will consider—

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: After the secondment.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, after the secondment means the House is adjourned—[Laughter]—Mr Speaker, that is like an own goal.

But, Mr Speaker, as you may direct, I second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let me thank all of you. Today is Friday and we do not intend to keep all of you in abeyance, so we will bring proceedings to a close.

Leadership, when are we coming on Monday?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, two o'clock on Monday.

Mr Second Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will, therefore, move to adjourn the House to Monday, 21st July, 2025 at two o'clock in the afternoon. The House stands adjourned.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 3.46 p.m. till Monday, 21st July, 2025 at 2 p.m.

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was corrected by the House on 28th July, 2025, as follows:

- (a) Column 12, paragraph 4, line 6,
“eighth” was deleted and “ninth”
inserted.
- (b) Column 41, item (w), line 3, “s”
was added to “service”
- (c) Column 42, paragraph 1, line 2.
“s” was added to “Interest”.
- (d) Column 55, item (p), line 2,
“Asante” was added to “Akim
North”